

U.S. HISTORY HACK

Unit 4

The 1920s

The Roaring Twenties · Mass Culture · Boom & Its Dangers · 1919–1929

Standards US.28 – US.38

US.28

US.29

US.30

US.31

US.32

US.33

US.34

US.35

US.36

US.37

US.38

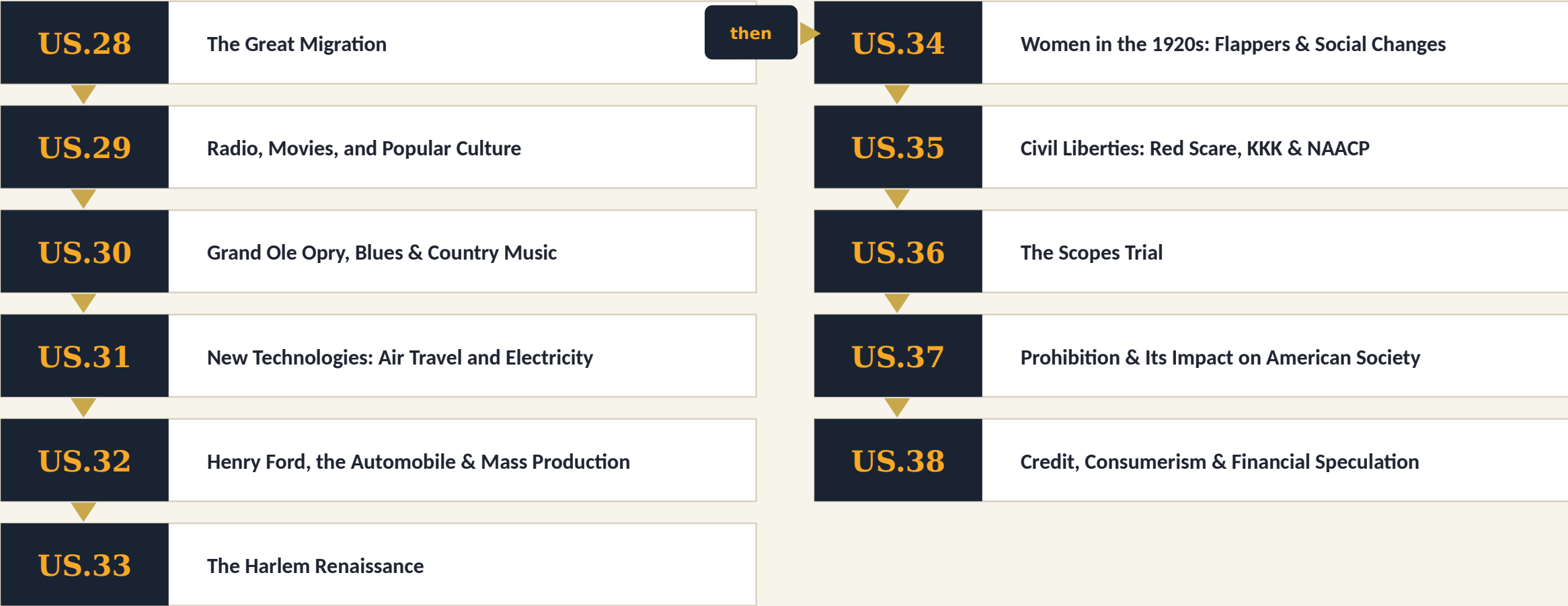
TCAP EOC LECTURE DECK · Tennessee Academic Standards for U.S. History

TroopToTeacher Technologies LLC

UNIT ROADMAP

Where We Are Headed

Unit 4 • The 1920s (1919–1929) — Migration, Mass Culture, New Technology & a Fragile Boom



BELL RINGER · HOOK

In 1919, most Americans had never heard a radio or driven a car.

By 1929, cars, radios, movies, and jazz had remade daily life — and then it all came crashing down.

How did a single decade transform American culture, technology, and everyday life — and why did that dazzling prosperity end in disaster?

TURN & TALK

With a partner, list three things you think were brand new or exciting about the 1920s, and one reason the good times might not have lasted. Keep your list; we will return to it at the end of the unit.

STANDARD

US.28

The Great Migration

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the impact of the Great Migration of African Americans that began in the post-World War I era from the rural South to the industrial regions of the Northeast and Midwest. (TCA)

I CAN

I can analyze the impact of the Great Migration of African Americans from the rural South to the industrial regions of the Northeast and Midwest in the post-World War I era.

How This Deck Works — UDL 3.0 & MTSS

Teacher reference · CAST UDL 3.0 guidelines designed into every standard

EVERY LEARNER · SAME FIRM GOAL

ENGAGEMENT

Multiple means of the “why”

- Welcoming Interests & Identities
- Sustaining Effort & Persistence
- Emotional Capacity

REPRESENTATION

Multiple means of the “what”

- Perception
- Language & Symbols
- Building Knowledge

ACTION & EXPRESSION

Multiple means of the “how”

- Interaction
- Expression & Communication
- Strategy Development

MTSS decision cycle: Tier 1 core for all → the Progress Check yields evidence → below mastery routes to targeted reteach (Tier 2, Teacher Guide §16); at/above mastery routes to extension. **The goal never lowers.**

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

Unit 3 What era did we just finish, and how did it end?

2

Unit Hook What is the big question of Unit 4?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What is the Great Migration?

✓ ANSWER

The movement of about six million Black Americans from the rural South to Northern and Midwestern cities in the early 20th century.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Between 1916 and 1970, roughly six million Black Americans packed their belongings and left the rural South for cities like Chicago, Detroit, and New York, one of the largest internal migrations in the nation's history.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why would millions of people leave the only home their families had known for generations, and how did that single decision reshape American cities forever?

Push Factors: Reasons to Leave the South

- Jim Crow laws enforced legal segregation and disenfranchisement, restricting opportunities for African Americans.
- The sharecropping system kept them in poverty through economic exploitation.
- Racial violence including lynchings, KKK terrorism, and legal injustice created dangerous conditions.
- Inferior segregated schools limited educational advancement, while the boll weevil destroyed cotton crops, reducing farm jobs.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Great Migration happened because _____ pushed Black Americans out of the South and _____ pulled them toward Northern cities.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee cities like Memphis and Nashville were both departure points and destinations in the Great Migration, and Memphis's Beale Street became a hub of the Black music and business culture migrants carried with them.



Chicago Commission on Race Relations, c1920 [The Negro in Chicago \(1922\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Pull Factors: Attractions of the North

- World War I created labor shortages in Northern factories, opening industrial jobs with significantly higher wages —average \$1,000+ annually versus \$300 in the South.
- Northern cities offered better schools and colleges, the ability to vote and participate in politics, less legally enforced segregation, and better housing, healthcare, and cultural opportunities.

Economic Opportunities Comparison

- In the South, African Americans were limited to sharecropping, domestic service, and agricultural labor.
- Northern cities offered factory work in steel mills, meatpacking, and railroads, plus domestic service, factory positions, and clerical work for women.
- Northern cities also allowed African American entrepreneurship and professional services.

Social and Cultural Changes

- Southern communities lost significant working-age population, affecting agricultural production and weakening traditional networks.
- Northern cities like Chicago, Detroit, and New York saw massive population growth, creation of African American neighborhoods and business districts, and the cultural flowering that led to the Harlem Renaissance.
- Social tensions arose from competition for jobs and housing.

Long-term Implications

- The Great Migration transformed America from rural to urban society.
- Concentrated African American voters in Northern cities increased political influence.
- Urban communities provided the base for future civil rights organizing.
- The migration created an African American middle class and spread jazz, blues, literature, and art from concentrated urban communities.
- Approximately 6 million African Americans migrated between 1910-1970.

Key Figure

African American Migrants

Six million who left the South



Chicago Commission on Race Relations, c1920 [The Negro in Chicago \(1922\)](#)

- Fled Jim Crow laws, violence, and sharecropping poverty (push factors)
- Sought jobs, higher wages, and voting rights in the North (pull factors)
- Reshaped Northern cities and built new Black communities

STRATEGY Frame the migration as thousands of individual decisions - use the Defender letter to make one migrant's reasoning concrete.

Letter from African American Migrant to Chicago Defender

Close Reading

Anonymous Southern Migrant • 1917



Chicago Commission on Race Relations, c1920 [The Negro in Chicago \(1922\)](#)

"I am in the darkness of the south and I am trying my best to get out. Oh please help me to get out of this low down country. I am counted no more than a dog here. I can do any kind of work from a shoe shine to farming. I would like to get my family out of this cursed place. Please sir help me and my family and God will bless you."

CONTEXT

The Great Migration was one of the most significant demographic shifts in American history. Between 1910 and 1970, over six million African Americans left the South for northern and western cities — driven out by Jim Crow laws, racial violence, sharecropping poverty, and boll weevil crop destruction, and drawn north by factory jobs, higher wages, and greater (though still limited) freedom. World War I accelerated the movement by creating massive demand for industrial labor as immigration from Europe stopped. Letters like this one, written by southern Black migrants to the Chicago Defender, capture the hopes and desperation that drove this monumental movement.

ANALYZE

What does this letter reveal about the "push factors" that motivated the Great Migration?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Anonymous Southern Migrant	1917	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Great Migration

Gran Migración

say: grayt my-GRAY-shun

GM

The mass movement of over 6 million African Americans from the rural South to urban areas in the North and Midwest between 1916 and 1970, driven by economic opportunity and escape from Jim Crow segregation.

NAACP (National Association for the Advancement of Colored People)

NAACP (Asociación Nacional para el Avance de las Personas de Color)

N

Founded in 1909, the nation's oldest civil rights organization that fought legal battles against segregation, lobbied for anti-lynching laws, and expanded significantly in the 1920s.

Harlem Renaissance

Renacimiento de Harlem

HR

A 1920s cultural movement centered in Harlem, New York, where African American artists, writers, musicians, and intellectuals celebrated Black culture and identity through art, literature, and music.

First Red Scare

Primer Susto Rojo

FR

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

Radio Broadcasting

Radiodifusión

RB

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

Automobile Impact

Impacto del Automóvil

AI

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Distinguish push vs. pull factors

MODEL PROMPT: Why did millions of African Americans leave the South after WWI?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The text names violence and Jim Crow as push factors, and Northern jobs and voting rights as pull factors. The migrant's letter shows both at once: he flees fear and chases wages.

THINK ALOUD

Label each reason in the section as PUSH (South) or PULL (North).

→ **Now you try:** *With a partner, decide whether push or pull mattered more, and cite one line as proof.*

Push and Pull — Mapping the Great Migration

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using your Cornell notes and the migrant's letter to the Chicago Defender, build a two-column chart of PUSH factors (reasons to leave the South) and PULL factors (attractions of the North). Place at least three factors in each column. Then write a one-sentence claim naming which set of factors mattered more and cite one piece of evidence from Direct Instruction or the primary source.

DELIVERABLE

Completed push/pull chart (3+ factors per column) AND a one-sentence, evidence-based claim about which mattered more.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with a word bank of factors provided; students place each in the correct column (no written claim required). Honors: Write a paragraph arguing to what extent the Great Migration delivered the freedom and opportunity migrants sought, using two pieces of evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us28-great-migration.pdf](https://www.trooptoteacher.com/cornell-notes/unit-4/us28-great-migration.pdf)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

According to this government report, what combination of factors caused the Great Migration?

- A** Only economic factors related to job opportunities in the North
- B** Labor demand from WWI, agricultural disaster, and social conditions in the South
- C** Government programs relocating workers to industrial centers
- D** Railroad companies offering free transportation to workers

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

According to this government report, what combination of factors caused the Great Migration?

- A** Only economic factors related to job opportunities in the North
- B** Labor demand from WWI, agricultural disaster, and social conditions in the South ✓
- C** Government programs relocating workers to industrial centers
- D** Railroad companies offering free transportation to workers

Correct answer: B. Why: The report identifies three causes: war creating labor demand, boll weevil destroying crops, and "social conditions of the Negro in the South."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Push Factors: Reasons to Leave the South
- Pull Factors: Attractions of the North
- Economic Opportunities Comparison
- Social and Cultural Changes
- Long-term Implications

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: To what extent did the Great Migration succeed in giving Black Americans the freedom and opportunity they sought? Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how push factors and pull factors together drove the Great Migration. Which do you think mattered more, and why?

STANDARD

US.29

Radio, Movies, and Popular Culture

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the growth and effects that radio and movies played in the emergence of popular culture, such as advertising, celebrities, news, and entertainment.

I CAN

I can describe the growth and effects that radio and movies played in the emergence of popular culture, such as advertising, celebrities, news, and entertainment.

Words you need before we read

Great Migration

En español: *Gran Migración*

WHAT IT MEANS

The mass movement of over 6 million African Americans from the rural South to urban areas in the North and Midwest between 1916 and 1970, driven by economic opportunity and escape from Jim Crow segregation.

First Red Scare

En español: *Primer Susto Rojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

Radio Broadcasting

En español: *Radiodifusión*

WHAT IT MEANS

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

Check your understanding

What social and cultural changes occurred in both Southern communities that lost population and Northern cities that gained it?

- A** Southern communities lost population and economic vitality while Northern cities saw neighborhood formation, business district growth, cultural flowering like the Harlem Renaissance, but also new racial tensions ✓ KEY
- B** Neither region experienced significant changes, but contemporary accounts suggest a different explanation, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved
- C** Only Northern cities experienced changes, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- D** Southern communities grew stronger after migration, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.28 What was the Great Migration?

2

US.28 Name one push factor and one pull factor of the Great Migration.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What new technology created a shared national culture in the 1920s?

✓ **ANSWER**

Radio broadcasting, which let millions of Americans hear the same programs at the same time.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In 1920 almost no American home had a radio; by 1929 more than twelve million families gathered around one every night, hearing the same voices, music, and news at the exact same moment for the first time in history.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

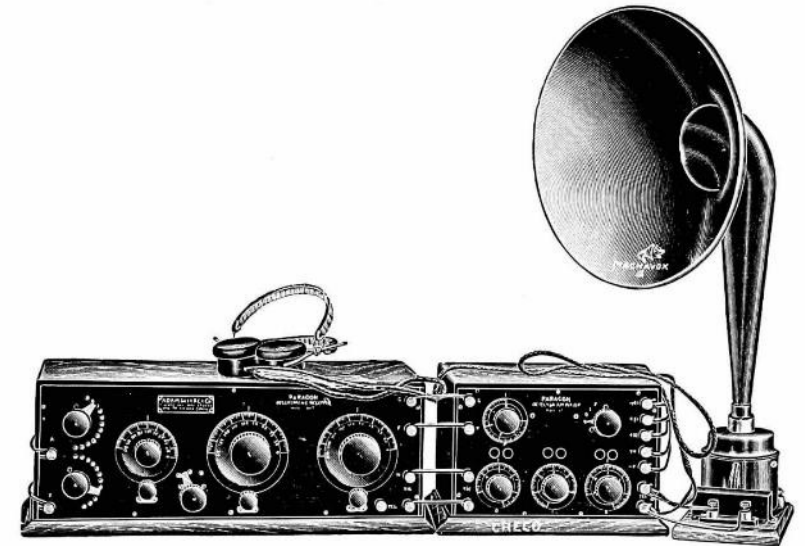
What happens to a country when, for the first time, millions of strangers can laugh at the same joke and hear the same song at the same second?

Radio's Impact on Popular Culture

- Radio became the first medium to reach the entire nation simultaneously.
- Ownership grew from 60,000 sets in 1922 to 10 million by 1929.
- Programming included music, news, sports, comedy shows, and serialized dramas.
- Radio created shared experiences across geographic and cultural boundaries, gave birth to consumer culture through commercialized advertising, and changed political campaigns as politicians could reach voters directly.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Radio and movies changed the 1920s by _____, which created a shared national _____.



Photographer unknown, c1922 [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Film Industry Growth

- Silent films made stars like Charlie Chaplin, Mary Pickford, and Rudolph Valentino global celebrities.
- Elaborate movie palaces made moviegoing a glamorous experience.
- Hollywood emerged as the entertainment capital, creating the "dream factory" mythology.
- By 1929, 50 million Americans attended movies weekly.
- The "talkies" revolution began in 1927 with "The Jazz Singer," which introduced sound films.



Photographer unknown, c1926 [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

Charlie Chaplin (1889-1977)

- Chaplin created "The Tramp"—an iconic character with bowler hat, cane, and mustache.
- He pioneered physical comedy and film techniques, achieving global appeal since silent films crossed language barriers.
- His character represented the common man struggling against modern industrial society.
- He founded United Artists studio and created social commentary films like "Modern Times."

Charles Lindbergh (1902-1974)

- "Lucky Lindy" completed the first solo nonstop transatlantic flight on May 20-21, 1927.
- He became a media sensation with ticker-tape parades, endorsements, and constant press coverage.
- As an aviation pioneer, he promoted commercial aviation and technological progress.
- Lindbergh embodied American ingenuity and adventurous spirit, becoming a national hero through newspapers, radio, and newsreels.

Babe Ruth (1895-1948)

- The "Sultan of Swat" transformed baseball from a pitching game to a hitting game.
- His 60 home runs in 1927 captivated national attention.
- His larger-than-life personality with a flamboyant lifestyle made him a cultural icon.
- Radio coverage brought baseball games to millions of fans, and Ruth became the first athlete to capitalize on celebrity for endorsements.
- Yankee Stadium was called "The House that Ruth Built."

Key Figures

Charlie Chaplin

Silent-film comedian & director (1889-1977)

- Created 'The Tramp,' the era's most recognized character
- Turned film into a mass-culture art form
- Built one of the first global celebrity brands

STRATEGY Use Chaplin to show how movies created a shared national culture across regions.

Charles Lindbergh

Aviator & national celebrity (1902-1974)



News photo (MOHAI), 1927
[Museum of History & Industry \(MOHAI\)](#)

- Made the first solo nonstop transatlantic flight (1927)
- Became the era's greatest hero
- Showed how radio and film could make an instant national celebrity

STRATEGY Connect Lindbergh to US.31: his fame was a product of the new technology and the new mass media.

Babe Ruth

Baseball superstar (1895-1948)

- Transformed baseball with his home-run power
- Became sports' first modern celebrity
- Symbolized the boom-time optimism of the decade

STRATEGY Use Ruth to introduce the idea of the celebrity athlete built by radio and newsreels.

Motion Picture Magazine Article

Close Reading

Photoplay Magazine • 1925



News photo, c1925 [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

"The motion picture has become the most democratic of all the arts. It speaks a universal language that all may understand. The immigrant from Europe, the farmer from Kansas, the society matron from New York—all sit side by side in the darkness of the theater, laughing at the same jokes, crying at the same sorrows, thrilling to the same adventures."

CONTEXT

The motion picture industry was transformed in the 1920s into America's dominant popular entertainment. By mid-decade, over 50 million Americans attended movies every week — in a country of 110 million. Hollywood studios churned out hundreds of films annually, creating a star system that turned actors like Charlie Chaplin, Mary Pickford, Douglas Fairbanks, and Rudolph Valentino into the first modern celebrities. Movie magazines like Photoplay fed the public's insatiable appetite for gossip about stars' private lives. The introduction of sound ('talkies') in 1927 with 'The Jazz Singer' ended the silent era and made movies even more popular. Hollywood projected American culture around the world.

ANALYZE

How did movies contribute to American popular culture according to this article?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Photoplay Magazine	1925	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Radio Broadcasting

Radiodifusión

RB

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

Commercial Aviation

Aviación Comercial

CA

The development of airplane technology and air travel in the 1920s, highlighted by Charles Lindbergh's 1927 solo transatlantic flight, which captured public imagination and demonstrated aviation's potential.

Grand Ole Opry

say: grand ohl AH-pree

Grand Ole Opry

GO

A weekly country music radio show that began in Nashville in 1925, becoming the longest-running radio broadcast in U.S. history and establishing Nashville as country music's capital.

Motion Pictures

Imágenes en Movimiento

MP

Silent and "talkie" films that became America's most popular entertainment in the 1920s, creating celebrity culture and Hollywood as the film capital of the world.

Consumerism

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

Consumismo

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

Electrification

say: ee-lek-truh-fih-KAY-shun

Electrificación

E

The spread of electrical power throughout America in the 1920s, transforming daily life with electric appliances, lighting, and machinery in homes and factories.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze cause and effect

MODEL PROMPT: How did radio and movies create a shared national culture?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Radio let millions hear the same broadcast, and films gave the whole country the same stars. That shared experience is what 'mass culture' means.

THINK ALOUD

Underline every effect of radio or film in the section.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain to a partner one way mass culture changed daily life, using a detail from the text.*

One Nation, One Broadcast — Mass Media Effects

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Using the radio and movie-palace images and your notes, complete a two-part organizer: (1) list three ways radio changed American life and (2) list three ways movies changed it. For each medium, mark one effect as 'unifying' the country and one as 'standardizing' culture. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether mass media brought Americans together or erased local differences.

DELIVERABLE

Completed two-part organizer (3 effects each for radio and film) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about mass media.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1927 [Library of Congress](#)

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer pre-labeled 'Radio' and 'Movies' with an effects word bank to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph comparing the cultural power of 1920s radio to a modern form of mass media, citing one example from each era.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us29-radio-movies-culture.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 1

EOC PRACTICE

How did movies contribute to American popular culture according to this article?

- A** They created separate entertainment for different social classes
- B** They united diverse Americans through shared emotional experiences
- C** They primarily served as educational tools for immigrants
- D** They replaced live theater as the only form of entertainment

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did movies contribute to American popular culture according to this article?

- A They created separate entertainment for different social classes
- B They united diverse Americans through shared emotional experiences ✓**
- C They primarily served as educational tools for immigrants
- D They replaced live theater as the only form of entertainment

Correct answer: B. Why: The article describes immigrants, farmers, and society members "sit side by side... laughing at the same jokes, crying at the same sorrows"—creating shared culture.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Radio's Impact on Popular Culture
- Film Industry Growth
- Charlie Chaplin (1889-1977)
- Charles Lindbergh (1902-1974)
- Babe Ruth (1895-1948)

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

*Evaluate: Did the new mass media of the 1920s unite Americans or erase important local and regional differences?
Argue your position with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how radio and movies created a shared national culture in the 1920s. Give one specific effect of each.

STANDARD

US.30

Grand Ole Opry, Blues & Country Music

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.05

Historical awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Examine how the use of the radio helped grow the popularity of country and blues music, including the rise of the Grand Ole Opry, W.C. Handy, and Bessie Smith. (TCA)

I CAN

I can examine how the use of the radio helped grow the popularity of country and blues music, including the rise of the Grand Ole Opry, W.C. Handy, and Bessie Smith.

Words you need before we read

Radio Broadcasting

En español: *Radiodifusión*

WHAT IT MEANS

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

Motion Pictures

En español: *Imágenes en Movimiento*

WHAT IT MEANS

Silent and "talkie" films that became America's most popular entertainment in the 1920s, creating celebrity culture and Hollywood as the film capital of the world.

Commercial Aviation

En español: *Aviación Comercial*

WHAT IT MEANS

The development of airplane technology and air travel in the 1920s, highlighted by Charles Lindbergh's 1927 solo transatlantic flight, which captured public imagination and demonstrated aviation's potential.

Check your understanding

Analyze how mass media in the 1920s created modern American popular culture and consumer society.

A Mass media had no impact on consumption patterns, which does not reflect the consensus among historians, although historical sources do not support this conclusion

B Radio and film advertising promoted consumer products to millions, celebrities modeled lifestyles and endorsed products, and shared entertainment created national markets for standardized goods

✓ KEY

C Consumer culture existed before mass media, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence

D Only wealthy Americans participated in consumer culture, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, which does not align with the documented historical record

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.29 How did radio change American life in the 1920s?

2

US.29 Why did Charles Lindbergh become such a national hero?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What Nashville radio program helped launch the country music industry?

✓ **ANSWER**

The Grand Ole Opry, first broadcast in 1925.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

On a Saturday night in 1925, a Nashville radio announcer flipped from a network opera broadcast to a fiddle tune and joked that listeners had just heard 'grand opera,' now they'd hear the 'Grand Ole Opry,' and a Tennessee institution was born.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did the music of poor Southern farmers and Black blues musicians become a national industry broadcast from Tennessee to the whole country?

Country Music Roots

- Country music originated from rural Southern folk traditions, Scottish-Irish ballads, and gospel music. Instruments included fiddle, banjo, guitar, harmonica, and later steel guitar.
- Themes centered on rural life, family, religion, hardship, and traditional values.
- Regional variations included Appalachian mountain music, Western swing, and honky-tonk.
- The 1920s recording industry brought rural music to national audiences.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Blues and country music grew out of _____, and became national industries because of _____.

Blues Music Evolution

- Blues evolved from African American work songs, field hollers, spirituals, and African musical traditions.
- The Mississippi Delta was the birthplace of Delta blues with its distinctive guitar style.
- Urban blues developed as African Americans migrated to cities like Chicago.
- The standard 12-bar structure became the foundation for popular music. Themes addressed love, loss, hardship, and resilience.



Carl Van Vechten / Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, c1936
[Library of Congress](#)

The Grand Ole Opry

- Beginning as "WSM Barn Dance" in Nashville on November 28, 1925, it was created and hosted by George D. Hay, the "Solemn Old Judge." It became the "Grand Ole Opry" in 1927.
- Saturday night live radio broadcasts reached millions across America, making Nashville the center of country music. The Opry preserved and promoted traditional American folk music, launched countless careers, and drew tourists to Nashville.
- The Ryman Auditorium hosted the Opry from 1943-1974.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

The Grand Ole Opry began as the 'WSM Barn Dance' broadcast from Nashville station WSM in 1925 and soon took its famous name. It made Nashville the capital of country music, a title Tennessee's capital still holds today.



Carl Van Vechten, 1941 [Library of Congress](#)

W.C. Handy (1873-1958): Father of the Blues

- W.C. Handy was the first to publish blues compositions for mainstream audiences.
- His "Memphis Blues" (1912) was the first published blues composition, and "St. Louis Blues" (1914) became a blues standard recorded by countless artists.
- A trained musician who studied European classical music, Handy combined African American folk traditions with formal musical notation.
- He founded Handy Brothers Music Company and proved African American music could achieve commercial success.

Bessie Smith (1894-1937): Empress of the Blues

- Bessie Smith was the most popular and influential blues singer of the 1920s.
- Her Columbia Records contract made her the highest-paid Black performer of her era.
- Her powerful voice featured emotional depth and perfect pitch on songs like "Downhearted Blues" and "St. Louis Blues." She earned up to \$2,000 per week during peak years, broke racial barriers, and performed for integrated audiences.
- Her influence extended to generations of singers including Billie Holiday and Janis Joplin.

Key Figures

W.C. Handy

'Father of the Blues' (1873-1958)



Carl Van Vechten, 1941 [Library of Congress](#)

- Published the first widely circulated blues compositions
- Popularized the blues form nationwide
- Bridged African American folk music and commercial recording

STRATEGY Read Handy's own words to show how he documented and formalized a folk tradition.

Bessie Smith

'Empress of the Blues' (1894-1937)



Carl Van Vechten, c1936 [Library of Congress](#)

- The most popular female blues singer of the 1920s
- Sold records in enormous numbers
- Showed the commercial power of Black artists on record

STRATEGY Use the record-sales report to prove the size of the audience for Black music.

W.C. Handy Autobiography Excerpt

Sourcing

W.C. Handy • 1941

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Carl Van Vechten, 1941 [Library of Congress](#)

"I wrote "Memphis Blues" in 1912 and "St. Louis Blues" in 1914. These were the first blues to be written down and published. Before this, the blues was folk music, passed along by ear. I wanted to capture on paper the sounds I heard in the cotton fields and on Beale Street. The sorrow songs of my people deserved to be preserved and heard by the world."

CONTEXT

W.C. Handy is often called the 'Father of the Blues' for popularizing blues music and bringing it to national audiences. Born in Alabama in 1873 to freed slaves, Handy grew up hearing the field hollers, spirituals, and work songs that would become the foundation of blues music. He began writing and publishing blues compositions around 1909, including 'Memphis Blues' (1912) and 'St. Louis Blues' (1914) — among the first blues songs to be written down and published commercially. His autobiography (1941) describes his early encounters with Delta blues musicians and his recognition that this music had commercial potential that he could develop.

ANALYZE

According to W.C. Handy, what was his contribution to American music?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	W.C. Handy	1941	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Grand Ole Opry

Grand Ole Opry

say: *grand ohl AH-pree*

GO

A weekly country music radio show that began in Nashville in 1925, becoming the longest-running radio broadcast in U.S. history and establishing Nashville as country music's capital.

Bessie Smith

Bessie Smith

say: *BESS-ee smith*

BS

The "Empress of the Blues," the most popular female blues singer of the 1920s whose powerful voice and emotional performances influenced generations of musicians.

Harlem Renaissance

Renacimiento de Harlem

HR

A 1920s cultural movement centered in Harlem, New York, where African American artists, writers, musicians, and intellectuals celebrated Black culture and identity through art, literature, and music.

W.C. Handy

W.C. Handy

say: *double-yoo see HAN-dee*

WH

Known as the "Father of the Blues," a musician and composer who published the first blues compositions and helped bring blues music from rural areas to mainstream audiences.

Radio Broadcasting

Radiodifusión

RB

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

Motion Pictures

Imágenes en Movimiento

MP

Silent and "talkie" films that became America's most popular entertainment in the 1920s, creating celebrity culture and Hollywood as the film capital of the world.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Trace an idea across sources

MODEL PROMPT: How did radio spread country and blues music to a national audience?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The WSM Barn Dance beamed the Opry across the country, and record sales carried the blues far beyond the South. Radio and records did the spreading.

THINK ALOUD

Find the Tennessee connection (the Grand Ole Opry) and mark it.

→ **Now you try:** *Name one artist and explain how technology grew that artist's audience.*

From the Hills to the Airwaves — Blues and Country Roots

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the W.C. Handy excerpt and the Bessie Smith record-sales report. Build a chart tracing how Southern folk music (blues and country) became a national industry: identify (1) where the music came from, (2) the technology that spread it (radio, records, the Grand Ole Opry), and (3) one key figure and their contribution. End with a one-sentence claim on how much credit Black musicians deserve for shaping American popular music.



Carl Van Vechten / Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, c1936 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed roots-to-industry chart (origin, technology, key figure) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with the three categories pre-labeled and a fact bank to place. Honors: Write a paragraph explaining how the Grand Ole Opry made Nashville the capital of country music, using one detail from the notes.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us30-blues-country-opry.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

According to W.C. Handy, what was his contribution to American music?

- A** He invented the blues as an entirely new musical form
- B** He was the first to formally write down and publish blues music
- C** He performed only in Memphis and refused to travel
- D** He rejected traditional African American musical influences

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

According to W.C. Handy, what was his contribution to American music?

- A He invented the blues as an entirely new musical form
- B He was the first to formally write down and publish blues music ✓**
- C He performed only in Memphis and refused to travel
- D He rejected traditional African American musical influences

Correct answer: B. Why: Handy states "These were the first blues to be written down and published" and that he "wanted to capture on paper" folk music previously "passed along by ear."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Country Music Roots
- Blues Music Evolution
- The Grand Ole Opry
- W.C. Handy (1873-1958): Father of the Blues
- Bessie Smith (1894-1937): Empress of the Blues

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: How much credit should Black musicians like W.C. Handy and Bessie Smith receive for shaping American popular music in the 1920s? Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how blues and country music of the 1920s both grew out of Southern life and became national industries. Use one figure as evidence.

STANDARD

US.31

New Technologies: Air Travel and Electricity

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the impact of new technologies of the era, including the advent of air travel and spread of electricity.

I CAN

I can describe the impact of new technologies of the era, including the advent of air travel and spread of electricity.

Words you need before we read

Grand Ole Opry

En español: *Grand Ole Opry*

WHAT IT MEANS

A weekly country music radio show that began in Nashville in 1925, becoming the longest-running radio broadcast in U.S. history and establishing Nashville as country music's capital.

W.C. Handy

En español: *W.C. Handy*

WHAT IT MEANS

Known as the "Father of the Blues," a musician and composer who published the first blues compositions and helped bring blues music from rural areas to mainstream audiences.

Bessie Smith

En español: *Bessie Smith*

WHAT IT MEANS

The "Empress of the Blues," the most popular female blues singer of the 1920s whose powerful voice and emotional performances influenced generations of musicians.

Check your understanding

Analyze how country and blues music reflected and influenced American cultural values and regional identity.

- A Music had no connection to cultural values, which represents a common misconception about the period, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- B Only wealthy Americans appreciated these genres, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- C Country celebrated rural, traditional, and religious values while blues expressed resilience and emotional depth; both preserved regional heritage, provided cultural identity for marginalized communities, and influenced mainstream American music** ✓ KEY
- D Country and blues had identical cultural messages, which does not reflect the consensus among historians and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.30 What is the Grand Ole Opry and where did it begin?

2

US.30 Who was W.C. Handy?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who made the first solo nonstop flight across the Atlantic in 1927?

✓ **ANSWER**

Charles Lindbergh, in the 'Spirit of St. Louis.'

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In May 1927, a shy airmail pilot named Charles Lindbergh climbed into a single-engine plane alone and flew 3,600 miles across the Atlantic Ocean nonstop, and returned to a hero's welcome of four million people in New York.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

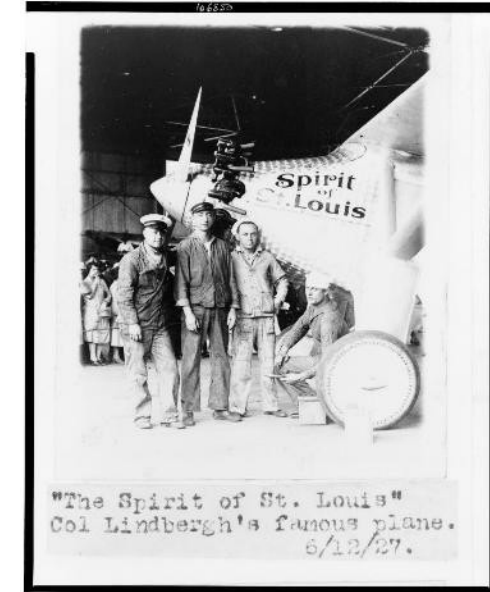
Why did one man's 33-hour flight, and the spread of electricity into ordinary homes, make Americans believe technology could transform their entire way of life?

Early Aviation Development

- The Wright Brothers achieved the first powered flight at Kitty Hawk, North Carolina in 1903.
- World War I accelerated aircraft development and pilot training.
- The Post Office began regular airmail routes in 1918, and first passenger airlines were established in the early 1920s.
- Charles Lindbergh's solo transatlantic flight in 1927 captured public imagination and promoted commercial aviation.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

New technologies like _____ and _____ changed daily life in the 1920s, but rural areas _____.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1927 [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Aviation's Revolutionary Impact

- Air travel reduced cross-country travel time from days to hours and connected previously isolated regions to the national economy.
- Commercial passenger miles increased from 6,000 in 1926 to 173,000 in 1929.
- Aviation created new industries and employment opportunities, facilitated global business and diplomatic relations, and enhanced national defense capabilities.
- Infrastructure including airports and navigation systems developed rapidly.

Spread of Electricity: Urban Transformation

- By 1930, 85% of urban homes had electricity, with power generation increasing from 6 billion kilowatt-hours in 1902 to 117 billion in 1929.
- Electric streetlights improved safety and extended business hours.
- Electric trolleys and subways revolutionized urban mobility.
- Electric elevators made skyscrapers practical.
- Electric signs, movie theaters, and amusement parks transformed urban entertainment.

Household and Industrial Transformation

- Electric household appliances—vacuum cleaners, washing machines, electric irons, and refrigerators—reduced domestic labor and improved living conditions.
- In manufacturing, electric motors increased productivity and allowed flexible factory layouts.
- New industries emerged in electrical equipment manufacturing, power generation, and appliance production.
- Electric lighting improved workplace safety and extended productive hours.

Rural Electrification Gap

- Only 10% of rural homes had electricity by 1930 due to cost and distance.
- This limited rural access to modern conveniences and productivity improvements.
- Where available, electric-powered farm equipment improved agricultural efficiency.
- The rural-urban electrification gap wouldn't be addressed until New Deal programs like TVA brought electricity to underserved areas.

Key Figure

Charles Lindbergh

Aviator (1902-1974)



News photo (MOHAI), 1927 [Museum of History & Industry \(MOHAI\)](#)

- Flew solo nonstop New York to Paris in 1927
- Proved long-distance air travel was possible
- Sparked public excitement and investment in aviation

STRATEGY Use Lindbergh's flight as the tipping point that turned aviation from stunt to industry.

Lindbergh Transatlantic Flight News Report

Contextualization

New York Times • May 22, 1927



News photo (MOHAI), 1927 [Museum of History & Industry \(MOHAI\)](#)

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.

"LINDBERGH DOES IT! TO PARIS IN 33½ HOURS. Flies 1,000 Miles Through Snow and Sleet; Cheering French Ones Carry Him Off Field. Captain Charles A. Lindbergh accomplished the greatest feat of a solitary man in the records of the human race yesterday when he landed his airplane, the Spirit of St. Louis, at Le Bourget Aerodrome."

CONTEXT

Charles Lindbergh's solo transatlantic flight from New York to Paris on May 20-21, 1927 was one of the defining moments of the 1920s — and perhaps of the entire 20th century. Flying his monoplane Spirit of St. Louis 3,600 miles in 33.5 hours, Lindbergh became the first person to complete a solo nonstop transatlantic flight and claimed the \$25,000 Orteig Prize. His arrival in Paris was greeted by 100,000 cheering spectators. In America, his return sparked the largest celebration of an individual in the nation's history. Lindbergh became a symbol of American technological achievement, individual heroism, and the limitless possibilities of the aviation age.

ANALYZE

How did the newspaper characterize Lindbergh's transatlantic flight?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	New York Times	May 22, 1927	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Commercial Aviation

Aviación Comercial

CA

The development of airplane technology and air travel in the 1920s, highlighted by Charles Lindbergh's 1927 solo transatlantic flight, which captured public imagination and demonstrated aviation's potential.

Automobile Impact

Impacto del Automóvil

AI

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Consumerism

Consumismo

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

Electrification

Electrificación

say: ee-lek-truh-fih-KAY-shun

E

The spread of electrical power throughout America in the 1920s, transforming daily life with electric appliances, lighting, and machinery in homes and factories.

Assembly Line

Línea de Ensamblaje

AL

A manufacturing method where workers remain stationary while products move past them on a conveyor belt, with each worker performing one specific task, dramatically increasing efficiency.

Radio Broadcasting

Radiodifusión

RB

The transmission of audio content over radio waves that revolutionized communication in the 1920s, creating mass media, national advertising, and shared popular culture.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Evaluate significance of
technology

MODEL PROMPT: Which mattered more to daily life - air travel or electrification?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Lindbergh's flight thrilled the nation, but electrification changed millions of homes and factories every day. Reach and daily impact are different measures.

THINK ALOUD

List one effect of aviation and one effect of electrification.

→ **Now you try:** *Decide which technology was more transformative and defend it with evidence.*

US.31 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

The Sky and the Switch — Technology Transforms Daily Life

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Using the Lindbergh news report and the rural electrification survey, complete a T-chart: on one side list ways AVIATION changed America; on the other list ways ELECTRICITY changed the home and workplace. Include at least two items per side, and star any item that did NOT reach rural areas. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether 1920s technology benefited all Americans equally.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1927 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed aviation/electricity T-chart (2+ items per side, rural gaps starred) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: T-chart with a word bank of technologies and effects to sort. Honors: Write a paragraph using the rural electrification gap to argue whether the 1920s 'technology boom' was truly national.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us31-aviation-electricity.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 1

EOC PRACTICE

How did the newspaper characterize Lindbergh's transatlantic flight?

- A** As a routine commercial aviation achievement
- B** As "the greatest feat of a solitary man in the records of the human race"
- C** As a dangerous stunt that should not be repeated
- D** As a failed attempt that barely succeeded

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did the newspaper characterize Lindbergh's transatlantic flight?

- A As a routine commercial aviation achievement
- B As "the greatest feat of a solitary man in the records of the human race" ✓**
- C As a dangerous stunt that should not be repeated
- D As a failed attempt that barely succeeded

Correct answer: B. Why: The Times calls it "the greatest feat of a solitary man in the records of the human race," showing how aviation captured public imagination.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Early Aviation Development
- Aviation's Revolutionary Impact
- Spread of Electricity: Urban Transformation
- Household and Industrial Transformation
- Rural Electrification Gap

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the technological changes of the 1920s benefit all Americans equally? Use the rural electrification gap as evidence to argue your position. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how advances in aviation and electricity changed American life in the 1920s. Give one example of each.

STANDARD

US.32

Henry Ford, the Automobile & Mass Production

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the impact of Henry T. Ford, the automobile, and the mass production of automobiles on the American economy and society.

I CAN

I can describe the impact of Henry Ford, the automobile, and the mass production of automobiles on the American economy and society.

Words you need before we read

Commercial Aviation

En español: *Aviación Comercial*

WHAT IT MEANS

The development of airplane technology and air travel in the 1920s, highlighted by Charles Lindbergh's 1927 solo transatlantic flight, which captured public imagination and demonstrated aviation's potential.

Electrification

En español: *Electrificación*

WHAT IT MEANS

The spread of electrical power throughout America in the 1920s, transforming daily life with electric appliances, lighting, and machinery in homes and factories.

Automobile Impact

En español: *Impacto del Automóvil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether technological innovations of the 1920s improved quality of life for all Americans or primarily benefited certain groups.

- A All Americans benefited equally from new technologies, but this fails to account for the broader historical context when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources
- B Technology only benefited the wealthy, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- C Rural Americans benefited more than urban residents, which does not align with the documented historical record, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D Urban, middle-class Americans benefited most from electricity and appliances, while rural areas lacked electrification and many workers faced job displacement from mechanization** ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.31 What did Charles Lindbergh's 1927 flight demonstrate about technology?

2

US.31 How did electrification change American homes in the 1920s?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What production method let Henry Ford build cars faster and cheaper?

✓ **ANSWER**

The moving assembly line, which broke work into small repeated steps.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

Henry Ford did not invent the automobile, but by putting the car on a moving assembly line he cut the time to build a Model T from twelve hours to ninety minutes, and dropped its price until an ordinary worker could own one.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How did one man's factory floor change not just how cars were built, but how Americans worked, shopped, dated, and lived?

Henry Ford's Revolutionary Role

- Ford founded the Ford Motor Company in 1903 with the goal of building affordable cars for average Americans.
- The Model T (1908-1927), nicknamed "Tin Lizzie," became America's first mass-produced automobile.
- Ford's assembly line (1913) used moving conveyor belts, interchangeable parts, and division of labor to revolutionize manufacturing.
- These innovations reduced Model T assembly time from 12 hours to 93 minutes.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Henry Ford transformed industry by using _____, and transformed society because _____.



Ford Motor Company, 1913 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Economic Impact on Manufacturing

- The assembly line became the standard for mass production industries, dramatically increasing productivity.
- Ford reduced Model T prices from \$825 (1908) to \$290 (1925), making automobiles affordable for middle-class consumers.
- By 1927, Ford had produced 15 million Model Ts and controlled 50% of the automobile market.
- His methods spread to other industries, establishing U.S. industrial leadership.

Impact on Labor Practices

- Ford's \$5 Day (1914) doubled typical industrial wages to reduce turnover and increase productivity.
- He reduced the workday from 9-10 hours to 8 hours.
- These innovations cut employee turnover from 370% to 16% and created a workforce that could afford to buy the products they made.
- However, assembly line work was repetitive, and Ford strongly resisted unionization.

Societal Transformation

- Automobiles gave Americans unprecedented personal mobility, ending rural isolation and enabling suburban development.
- Cars changed dating and courtship patterns, providing privacy and mobility for young people.
- Sunday drives and family vacations became popular activities.
- Automobile ownership became a measure of social success and enabled new patterns of work, shopping, and leisure.

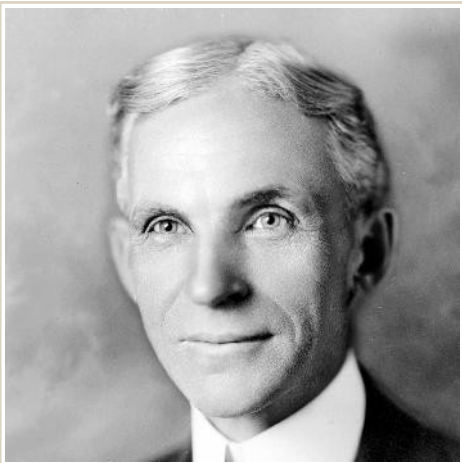
Supporting Industries and Infrastructure

- The automobile industry drove expansion of steel, rubber, glass, and petroleum industries.
- Gas stations, repair shops, motels, and auto parts stores proliferated.
- Massive road construction programs transformed the American landscape.
- Detroit became "Motor City," attracting workers nationwide.
- The automobile industry directly and indirectly employed millions of Americans.

Key Figure

Henry Ford

Automobile manufacturer



Hartsook (studio), c1919 [Library of Congress](#)

- Perfected the moving assembly line for the Model T
- Introduced the \$5 workday (1914)
- Made cars affordable for ordinary Americans

STRATEGY Pair the assembly-line description with the \$5-Day announcement to show mass production and mass consumption together.

Ford \$5 Day Announcement

Close Reading

Henry Ford • January 5, 1914



Ford Motor Company, 1913 [Wikimedia Commons](#)

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.

"The Ford Motor Company, the greatest and most successful automobile manufacturing company in the world, will, on January 12, inaugurate the greatest revolution in the matter of rewards for its workers ever known to the industrial world. At one stroke it will reduce the hours of labor from nine to eight, and add to every man's pay a share of the profits of the house. The smallest amount to be received by a man 22 years old and upwards will be \$5 per day."

CONTEXT

On January 5, 1914, Henry Ford shocked the business world by announcing that Ford Motor Company would pay its workers a minimum of \$5 per day — roughly double the prevailing factory wage at the time. Ford's motives were partly practical: the assembly line had made work so monotonous that turnover was astronomical (Ford hired 52,000 workers to maintain a workforce of 14,000 in 1913). The \$5 day reduced turnover, increased productivity, and generated enormous positive publicity. It also, as Ford himself noted, allowed workers to afford the very cars they were building — contributing to the rise of mass consumer society. However, the \$5 day came with strict moral and behavioral requirements that Ford's 'Sociological Department' enforced through home inspections.

ANALYZE

What did Ford's \$5 day policy represent in American industrial history?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Henry Ford	January 5, 1914	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [The Henry Ford](#)

Word Wall

Henry Ford

say: HEN-ree ford

Henry Ford

HF

Automobile manufacturer who revolutionized production with the assembly line, making the Model T affordable for average Americans and transforming society.

Automobile Impact

Impacto del Automóvil

AI

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Consumerism

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

Consumismo

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

Assembly Line

Línea de Ensamblaje

AL

A manufacturing method where workers remain stationary while products move past them on a conveyor belt, with each worker performing one specific task, dramatically increasing efficiency.

Buying on Credit

Compra a Crédito

BO

The practice of purchasing goods with borrowed money repaid over time in installments, which fueled 1920s consumer spending.

Electrification

say: ee-lek-truh-fih-KAY-shun

Electrificación

E

The spread of electrical power throughout America in the 1920s, transforming daily life with electric appliances, lighting, and machinery in homes and factories.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Connect production to
consumption

MODEL PROMPT: How did Ford's assembly line change both work and society?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The moving line made cars cheap; the \$5 day let workers afford them. Mass production and mass consumption fed each other.

THINK ALOUD

Circle the effect on workers and the effect on ordinary buyers.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain how the automobile reshaped where and how Americans lived.*

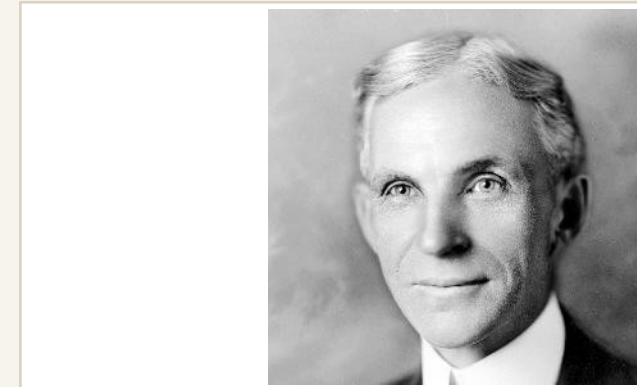
Ninety Minutes to a Model T — The Assembly Line Effect

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Ford assembly-line description and the \$5 Day announcement. Create a cause-and-effect web starting from 'moving assembly line' and branching to at least four effects: on price, on workers, on the consumer middle class, and on daily American life (where people lived, worked, shopped). Then write a one-sentence claim on whether Ford's biggest impact was on the economy or on everyday life.



Hartsook (studio), c1919 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed cause-and-effect web (4+ effects) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about Ford's greatest impact.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Web with the four effect branches pre-labeled and a word bank to fill in. Honors: Write a paragraph explaining how the \$5 Day helped create the very consumers who bought Ford's cars, citing the announcement.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us32-ford-assembly-line.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What did Ford's \$5 day policy represent in American industrial history?

- A** A reduction in worker wages to increase company profits
- B** A revolutionary increase in wages combined with shorter work hours
- C** A requirement for workers to purchase Ford automobiles
- D** An elimination of profit-sharing programs for workers

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What did Ford's \$5 day policy represent in American industrial history?

- A A reduction in worker wages to increase company profits
- B A revolutionary increase in wages combined with shorter work hours ✓**
- C A requirement for workers to purchase Ford automobiles
- D An elimination of profit-sharing programs for workers

Correct answer: B. Why: Ford announced reducing hours "from nine to eight" while raising pay to "\$5 per day"—described as "the greatest revolution... in rewards for its workers."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Henry Ford's Revolutionary Role
- Economic Impact on Manufacturing
- Impact on Labor Practices
- Societal Transformation
- Supporting Industries and Infrastructure

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

Evaluate: Was Henry Ford's greatest impact on the American economy or on American everyday life? Defend your claim with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how Henry Ford's assembly line and \$5 day transformed both industry and society in the 1920s.

STANDARD

US.33

The Harlem Renaissance

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.01

Collect sources

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.05

Historical awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the impact of the Harlem Renaissance and its important figures on American culture, including: Louis Armstrong, Duke Ellington, Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, James Weldon Johnson. (TCA)

I CAN

I can analyze the impact of the Harlem Renaissance and its important figures on American culture, including Louis Armstrong, Duke Ellington, Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, and James Weldon Johnson.

Words you need before we read

■ Henry Ford

En español: *Henry Ford*

WHAT IT MEANS

Automobile manufacturer who revolutionized production with the assembly line, making the Model T affordable for average Americans and transforming society.

■ Assembly Line

En español: *Línea de Ensamblaje*

WHAT IT MEANS

A manufacturing method where workers remain stationary while products move past them on a conveyor belt, with each worker performing one specific task, dramatically increasing efficiency.

■ Automobile Impact

En español: *Impacto del Automóvil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Check your understanding

Analyze whether Ford's contributions to American economy and society were more positive or negative overall.

- A** Ford's innovations brought affordable transportation, higher wages, and economic growth, but also repetitive assembly work, anti-union policies, and American dependence on fossil fuels and automobile infrastructure ✓ KEY
- B** Ford's contributions were entirely positive, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but closer analysis reveals a more complicated historical reality, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- C** Ford's contributions were entirely negative, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, which ignores significant political and cultural developments of the era
- D** Ford had no significant impact on American society, yet the available evidence points to a different conclusion, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.32 How did Henry Ford's assembly line change manufacturing?

2

US.32 What was Ford's '\$5 day' and why did it matter?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the Harlem Renaissance?

✓ ANSWER

A 1920s flowering of African American art, literature, and music centered in Harlem.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the 1920s the Harlem neighborhood of New York City exploded with Black poets, novelists, painters, and jazz musicians, an artistic movement so powerful it announced that African American culture was American culture.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

Why did a few square miles of one New York neighborhood produce a burst of art and music that still shapes the world today?

Historical Context and Characteristics

- The Harlem Renaissance (approximately 1918-1937, peak in 1920s) was centered in Harlem, Manhattan.
- The Great Migration created concentrated urban African American communities.
- Post-WWI, Black veterans returned with new expectations.
- The "New Negro Movement" promoted pride in African American identity.
- Key venues included the Cotton Club, Apollo Theater, and Schomburg Center.
- Crisis and Opportunity magazines showcased new talent.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Harlem Renaissance was _____, and it mattered because _____.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, c1920s-1930s [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Impact on African American Arts

- The Renaissance produced an explosion of creativity in literature, music, visual arts, and theater.
- New poetry forms expressed African American experience and pride.
- Realistic novels challenged stereotypes.
- Artists like Aaron Douglas created distinctive African American visual styles.
- Plays explored Black themes, and musical theater shows like "Shuffle Along" brought Black performers to Broadway.



Unknown, c1920s [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

Louis Armstrong (1901-1971)

- Armstrong transformed jazz from ensemble music to a soloist-centered art form.
- His revolutionary trumpet technique and improvisational skills redefined the genre.
- He pioneered scat singing and recorded influential sessions with his Hot Five and Hot Seven groups.
- His charismatic personality made jazz accessible to mainstream audiences, and he became a cultural ambassador spreading American jazz internationally.

Duke Ellington (1899-1974)

- Ellington led a sophisticated orchestra for over 50 years, composing over 1,000 works including "Mood Indigo" and "Sophisticated Lady." His Cotton Club residency (1927-1931) made him nationally famous.
- A master of orchestration who blended jazz with classical music, Ellington elevated jazz to serious art form status.
- He insisted on dignity and respect for African American musicians.

Langston Hughes and Zora Neale Hurston

- Hughes (1902-1967) captured African American experience in poetry collections like "The Weary Blues" (1926), incorporating jazz rhythms and vernacular language.
- His "Dream Deferred" questioned American equality.
- Hurston (1891-1960) wrote the masterpiece "Their Eyes Were Watching God" (1937), collected African American folklore, and created strong female protagonists.
- Both used authentic voice to celebrate Black culture while challenging discrimination.

Key Figures

Langston Hughes

Poet of the Harlem Renaissance



- Wrote 'The Negro Speaks of Rivers' and 'The Negro Artist and the Racial Mountain'
- Gave voice to Black pride and everyday life

STRATEGY Read a Hughes line aloud, then have students name the identity he is asserting.

Louis Armstrong

Jazz trumpeter & singer (1901-1971)



- Revolutionized jazz with improvised solos
- Became one of the most influential musicians in history

STRATEGY Use Armstrong to show jazz as the sound of the Harlem Renaissance and the decade.

Duke Ellington

Jazz composer & bandleader (1899-1974)



- Led his orchestra for nearly 50 years
- Composed sophisticated 'big band' jazz

STRATEGY Contrast Ellington's polished composition with Armstrong's improvisation to show jazz's range.

Zora Neale Hurston

Novelist & folklorist



- Collected and celebrated Southern Black folklore
- Wrote in authentic dialect and voice

STRATEGY Use Hurston to broaden the Renaissance beyond Harlem to Southern Black culture.

The Negro Artist and the Racial Mountain

Argumentation

Langston Hughes • 1926



Carl Van Vechten / Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, c1936
[Library of Congress](#)

"We younger Negro artists who create now intend to express our individual dark-skinned selves without fear or shame. If white people are pleased we are glad. If they are not, it doesn't matter. We know we are beautiful. And ugly too. The tom-tom cries and the tom-tom laughs. If colored people are pleased we are glad. If they are not, their displeasure doesn't matter either."

CONTEXT

Langston Hughes's 1926 essay 'The Negro Artist and the Racial Mountain' was a manifesto for the Harlem Renaissance's most ambitious artists. Hughes argued against Black artists who tried to imitate white artistic standards or who were ashamed of the jazz, blues, and folk traditions of ordinary Black life. He celebrated the 'low-down folks' — the workers and poor people of Harlem — as the true source of authentic Black artistic expression. The essay was a direct response to an older Black critic who had said that a promising young Black poet wanted to be white — which Hughes interpreted as wanting to write 'white' poetry. Hughes argued for a Black art rooted in Black experience.

ANALYZE

What artistic philosophy did Langston Hughes advocate for African American artists?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Langston Hughes	1926	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Harlem Renaissance

Renacimiento de Harlem

HR

A 1920s cultural movement centered in Harlem, New York, where African American artists, writers, musicians, and intellectuals celebrated Black culture and identity through art, literature, and music.

Duke Ellington

Duke Ellington

say: dook EL-ing-tun

DE

A prolific jazz composer, pianist, and bandleader who led his orchestra for nearly 50 years, creating sophisticated jazz compositions that elevated the genre to high art.

Zora Neale Hurston

Zora Neale Hurston

say: ZOR-uh neel HUR-stun

ZN

An anthropologist, folklorist, and novelist who celebrated Southern Black culture and dialect in her masterpiece "Their Eyes Were Watching God."

Louis Armstrong

Louis Armstrong

say: LOO-ee ARM-strong

LA

A revolutionary jazz trumpeter and singer from New Orleans who became one of the most influential musicians of the 20th century, pioneering improvisational jazz and scat singing.

Langston Hughes

Langston Hughes

say: LANG-stun hyooz

LH

A leading poet, novelist, and playwright of the Harlem Renaissance who wrote powerfully about the Black experience in America, using jazz rhythms and everyday language.

James Weldon Johnson

James Weldon Johnson

say: jaymz WEL-dun JON-sun

JW

A writer, diplomat, and civil rights activist who wrote "Lift Every Voice and Sing" (known as the Black National Anthem) and led the NAACP.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Interpret an author's claim

MODEL PROMPT: What did Harlem Renaissance artists say about Black identity?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Hughes insists Black artists should create from their own experience, not imitate white culture. That is a claim of pride and independence.

THINK ALOUD

Underline the sentence where the author states the purpose of Black art.

→ **Now you try:** *Paraphrase the author's argument in one sentence, then cite the line that proves it.*

Harlem's Voices — A Renaissance Exhibit Card

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read 'The Negro Speaks of Rivers' and the excerpt from 'The Negro Artist and the Racial Mountain.' Create an exhibit card profiling ONE Harlem Renaissance figure (Langston Hughes, Zora Neale Hurston, Louis Armstrong, Duke Ellington, or James Weldon Johnson): include their field, one major work or contribution, and how they expressed Black identity and pride. End with a one-sentence claim on why the Harlem Renaissance mattered to American culture.



Unknown, c1920s [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed exhibit card (field, contribution, expression of identity) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Exhibit-card template with labeled sections and a figure fact bank. Honors: Add a paragraph analyzing how Hughes's poem uses history to build pride, quoting one line.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us33-harlem-renaissance.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What artistic philosophy did Langston Hughes advocate for African American artists?

- A** African American artists should imitate European artistic traditions
- B** Artists should create authentically without seeking approval from any group
- C** Black artists must only create work that white audiences will appreciate
- D** Art should avoid addressing racial themes to reach broader audiences

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What artistic philosophy did Langston Hughes advocate for African American artists?

- A African American artists should imitate European artistic traditions
- B Artists should create authentically without seeking approval from any group ✓**
- C Black artists must only create work that white audiences will appreciate
- D Art should avoid addressing racial themes to reach broader audiences

Correct answer: B. Why: Hughes declares artists will "express our individual dark-skinned selves without fear or shame" regardless of whether white or Black audiences approve.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Historical Context and Characteristics
- Impact on African American Arts
- Louis Armstrong (1901-1971)
- Duke Ellington (1899-1974)
- Langston Hughes and Zora Neale Hurston

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

*Evaluate: To what extent did the Harlem Renaissance change how Americans viewed Black culture and identity?
Argue your position with at least two pieces of evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain what the Harlem Renaissance was and why it mattered to American culture. Use at least two figures as evidence.

STANDARD

US.34

Women in the 1920s: Flappers & Social Changes

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.01

Collect sources

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe changes and limitations in the social and economic status of women during this era, including flappers, birth control, clerical and office jobs, and the rise of women's colleges.

I CAN

I can describe changes and limitations in the social and economic status of women during this era, including flappers, birth control, clerical and office jobs, and the rise of women's colleges.

Words you need before we read

■ Harlem Renaissance

En español: *Renacimiento de Harlem*

WHAT IT MEANS

A 1920s cultural movement centered in Harlem, New York, where African American artists, writers, musicians, and intellectuals celebrated Black culture and identity through art, literature, and music.

■ Louis Armstrong

En español: *Louis Armstrong*

WHAT IT MEANS

A revolutionary jazz trumpeter and singer from New Orleans who became one of the most influential musicians of the 20th century, pioneering improvisational jazz and scat singing.

■ Duke Ellington

En español: *Duke Ellington*

WHAT IT MEANS

A prolific jazz composer, pianist, and bandleader who led his orchestra for nearly 50 years, creating sophisticated jazz compositions that elevated the genre to high art.

Check your understanding

Analyze how the Harlem Renaissance challenged racial stereotypes and influenced American culture beyond the 1920s.

- A The Renaissance had no lasting cultural impact, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- B The Renaissance demonstrated African American intellectual and artistic capabilities, challenged stereotypes through achievement, established jazz as American art, influenced the Civil Rights Movement, and continues to inspire artists today** ✓ KEY
- C The Renaissance ended racism in America, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- D Its influence was limited to Harlem, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.33 What was the Harlem Renaissance?

2

US.33 Name two major figures of the Harlem Renaissance.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

Who were the flappers?

✓ ANSWER

Young women of the 1920s who broke with tradition through new fashion, behavior, and independence.

COMMIT FIRST: have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.

Think About It

In the 1920s a new kind of young woman, the 'flapper,' bobbed her hair, raised her hemline, danced the Charleston, and voted for the first time, shocking her parents and redefining what a woman could be.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How much did life really change for American women in the 1920s, and how much stayed exactly the same?

Flappers and Cultural Significance

- Flappers were young, modern women who rejected Victorian values.
- Their characteristics included short "bob" haircuts, short skirts, makeup, and fashionable clothing.
- They smoked, drank, danced, dated unchaperoned, and spoke frankly about sexuality.
- Flappers emphasized individual choice over family duty, exercised newly won voting rights, and became targets of advertising.
- They sparked debates about morality and family values.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Women's lives changed in the 1920s when _____, but stayed the same because _____.



Turner, C. W., photographer, c1922 [Library of Congress](#)

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Birth Control and Reproductive Rights

- Margaret Sanger founded the American Birth Control League (predecessor to Planned Parenthood), opened the first birth control clinic in Brooklyn (1916), and was arrested multiple times for distributing contraceptive information.
- Average family size decreased from 7 children (1800) to 3 children (1930).
- Birth control gave women more control over their bodies, improved maternal health, and allowed women to pursue education and careers.

Clerical and Office Jobs

- The service economy created millions of clerical positions.
- Women in clerical work increased from 75,000 (1900) to 1.4 million (1930).
- Jobs included secretaries, stenographers, typists, telephone operators, and bookkeepers.
- Office work paid better than factory or domestic work and offered cleaner, safer conditions.
- However, women faced lower pay than men, limited advancement, and "marriage bars" requiring women to quit when they married.

Rise of Women's Colleges

- The Seven Sisters and other women's colleges provided education equivalent to men's institutions.
- Programs prepared women for teaching, nursing, social work, and business careers.
- Female professors served as role models, and alumni networks helped graduates find employment.
- Women's colleges challenged assumptions about female intellectual capabilities and produced leaders in progressive reform movements.

Limitations and Contradictions

- Despite changes, most women remained in traditional roles.
- A "glass ceiling" limited advancement to executive positions.
- Pay inequality persisted with women earning significantly less for similar work.
- Flapper culture was primarily urban and middle-class.
- Conservative backlash criticized modern women as immoral.
- Most professional schools still excluded women, and marriage often ended careers.

Key Figures

The Flapper

Symbol of the 'New Woman'



Turner, C. W., photographer, c1922
[Library of Congress](#)

- Bobbed hair, short skirts, and public independence
- Challenged Victorian rules for women
- Became the media image of 1920s youth culture

STRATEGY Have students separate the media image of the flapper from the real, limited gains for most women.

Margaret Sanger

Birth-control activist



Underwood & Underwood, c1922 [Library of Congress](#)

- Led the movement to legalize contraception
- Founded birth-control clinics
- Framed reproductive choice as a women's-rights issue

STRATEGY Use Sanger to show that 1920s change for women was contested and legally risky, not simply granted.

Margaret Sanger on Birth Control

Sourcing

Margaret Sanger • 1920

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Underwood & Underwood, c1922 [Library of Congress](#)

"No woman can call herself free who does not own and control her body. No woman can call herself free until she can choose consciously whether she will or will not be a mother. Birth control is woman's problem. The quicker she accepts it as hers and hers alone, the quicker will society respect motherhood."

CONTEXT

Margaret Sanger was the founder of what would become Planned Parenthood and the most important advocate for birth control in American history. In 1920, when this excerpt was published, birth control was illegal in most states under the Comstock Laws (1873), which classified contraceptive information as obscene material. Sanger had already been arrested multiple times for distributing birth control information and opening a clinic in Brooklyn. Her advocacy combined feminist arguments about women's autonomy with eugenicist beliefs about 'unfit' populations — a troubling combination that reflected both progressive feminist politics and the disturbing racial and class assumptions widespread in progressive circles.

ANALYZE

According to Margaret Sanger, why was birth control essential for women's freedom?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Margaret Sanger	1920	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Flappers

say: FLAP-erz

Flappers

F

Young women in the 1920s who challenged traditional gender norms by wearing short skirts and bobbed hair, dancing, drinking, smoking, and asserting independence.

Women in the Workforce

Mujeres en la Fuerza Laboral

WI

The 1920s saw increased female employment in clerical and office jobs, though women still faced discrimination, lower wages, and were often expected to leave work upon marriage.

Automobile Impact

Impacto del Automóvil

AI

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Birth Control Movement

Movimiento de Control de Natalidad

BC

Led by Margaret Sanger, the campaign to legalize contraception and provide women reproductive choice, facing opposition from religious and conservative groups.

Consumerism

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

Consumismo

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

Motion Pictures

Imágenes en Movimiento

MP

Silent and "talkie" films that became America's most popular entertainment in the 1920s, creating celebrity culture and Hollywood as the film capital of the world.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Separate image from reality

MODEL PROMPT: How much did life really change for women in the 1920s?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The flapper image suggests total freedom, but the text shows women still faced job limits, unequal pay, and legal fights over birth control. Image and reality differ.

THINK ALOUD

List one real gain and one real limitation for women.

→ **Now you try:** *Write one sentence stating whether 1920s change for women was large or limited, with evidence.*

US.34 · STUDENT ACTIVITY

New Woman or New Style? — Change and Continuity for Women

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the flapper defense article and Margaret Sanger's statement on birth control. Build a two-column chart: WHAT CHANGED for women in the 1920s (voting, jobs, colleges, fashion, freedom) and WHAT STAYED THE SAME (expectations to marry, lower pay, limited careers, who got the new freedoms). List at least three per column. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether the 1920s brought real liberation or mostly a change in image.

DELIVERABLE

Completed change/continuity chart (3+ per column) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.



Turner, C. W., photographer, c1922 [Library of Congress](#)

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart with a word bank to sort into 'changed' vs. 'stayed the same.' Honors: Write a paragraph arguing which women benefited most from the changes of the 1920s, and which were left out.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us34-women-1920s.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

According to Margaret Sanger, why was birth control essential for women's freedom?

- A** It would help reduce poverty in urban immigrant communities
- B** True freedom required women to control their own bodies and reproductive choices
- C** Birth control would allow women to compete with men in all careers
- D** It was primarily a health issue rather than a freedom issue

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

According to Margaret Sanger, why was birth control essential for women's freedom?

- A** It would help reduce poverty in urban immigrant communities
- B** True freedom required women to control their own bodies and reproductive choices ✓
- C** Birth control would allow women to compete with men in all careers
- D** It was primarily a health issue rather than a freedom issue

Correct answer: B. Why: Sanger states "No woman can call herself free who does not own and control her body" or "choose consciously whether she will or will not be a mother."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Flappers and Cultural Significance
- Birth Control and Reproductive Rights
- Clerical and Office Jobs
- Rise of Women's Colleges
- Limitations and Contradictions

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Did the 1920s represent real liberation for women or mostly a change in style and image?
Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how life changed for American women in the 1920s AND how it stayed the same. Give one example of each.

STANDARD

US.35

Civil Liberties: Red Scare, KKK & NAACP

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.03

Synthesize sources

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including: First Red Scare, Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s, Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan, Black Wall Street and Tulsa Massacre, Rise of the NAACP, Efforts of Ida B. Wells-Barnett, Emergence of Garveyism. (TCA)

I CAN

I can examine challenges and advancements related to the push for civil liberties, including the First Red Scare, Immigration Quota Acts, resurgence of the KKK, Black Wall Street and Tulsa Massacre, rise of the NAACP, Ida B. Wells-Barnett, and Garveyism.

Words you need before we read

■ Flappers

En español: *Flappers*

WHAT IT MEANS

Young women in the 1920s who challenged traditional gender norms by wearing short skirts and bobbed hair, dancing, drinking, smoking, and asserting independence.

■ Birth Control Movement

En español: *Movimiento de Control de Natalidad*

WHAT IT MEANS

Led by Margaret Sanger, the campaign to legalize contraception and provide women reproductive choice, facing opposition from religious and conservative groups.

■ Women in the Workforce

En español: *Mujeres en la Fuerza Laboral*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1920s saw increased female employment in clerical and office jobs, though women still faced discrimination, lower wages, and were often expected to leave work upon marriage.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether the social and economic changes of the 1920s fundamentally improved women's status or were primarily superficial.

- A Changes completely transformed women's status, although historical sources do not support this conclusion, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B No meaningful changes occurred for women, although historical sources do not support this conclusion and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which does not align with the documented historical record
- C While voting rights, education access, and work opportunities expanded, persistent pay inequality, limited advancement, marriage bars, and traditional expectations meant fundamental gender inequality continued ✓ KEY**
- D Only rural women experienced significant changes, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise and fails to account for key developments in the broader context

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.34 Who were the 'flappers' and what did they represent?

2

US.34 What major political right did women gain at the start of the 1920s?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the First Red Scare?

✓ **ANSWER**

Post-WWI fear of communism and radicalism that led to raids, arrests, and deportations.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the same decade that celebrated jazz and freedom, the Ku Klux Klan grew to over four million members, the government rounded up and deported suspected radicals, and Congress slammed the door on immigrants from most of the world.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

How could the 'Roaring Twenties' be a time of new freedom and, at the very same time, a time of fear, prejudice, and shrinking civil liberties?

First Red Scare (1919-1920)

- Fear of communist revolution spreading from Russia combined with labor strikes and anarchist bombings created hysteria.
- Attorney General Palmer authorized raids on suspected radicals, arresting over 6,000 people, many without warrants.
- Hundreds of immigrants were deported without due process.
- Socialist publications were banned, and meetings disrupted.
- Constitutional rights including free speech and due process were violated in the name of security.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

In the 1920s civil liberties shrank because of _____, _____, and _____.



News photo, 1921 [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

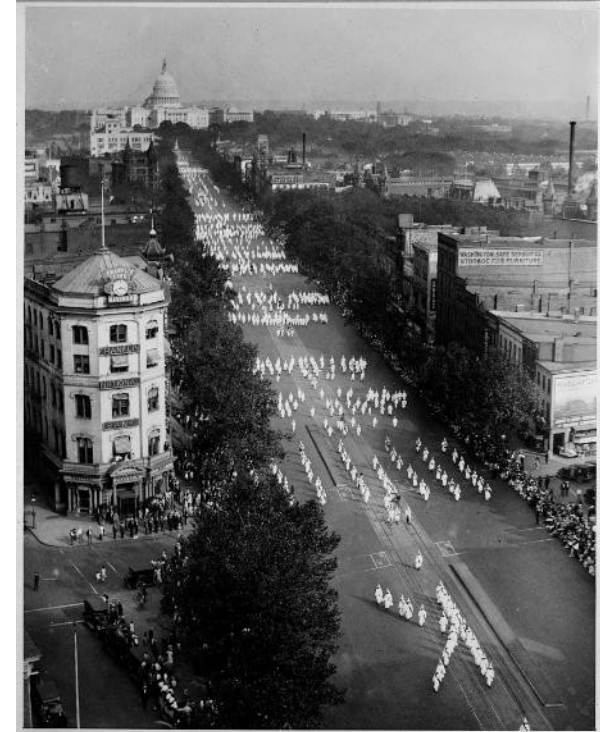
TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s

- The Emergency Quota Act (1921) limited immigration to 3% of each nationality present in 1910.
- The National Origins Act (1924) reduced this to 2% based on 1890 census, favoring Northern and Western Europeans while completely banning Asian immigration.
- Total annual immigration was capped at 150,000.
- These laws dramatically altered American demographics and separated many families.

Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan

- The film "Birth of a Nation" (1915) romanticized the original KKK and inspired revival.
- The new Klan opposed Catholics, Jews, and immigrants in addition to African Americans, extending beyond the South to Midwest and West. Peak membership reached 4-5 million in the mid-1920s.
- The KKK engaged in violence, influenced elections, and promoted economic boycotts before scandals caused decline by 1930.



National Photo Company / Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1926
[Library of Congress](#)

Ida B. Wells (1862-1931)

- Wells documented and publicized lynching statistics through investigative journalism.
- Her work "Southern Horrors" (1892) exposed myths about lynching.
- She spoke internationally to build pressure against racial violence and co-founded the NAACP.
- Wells advocated for both civil rights and women's suffrage despite facing death threats and character attacks for her militant stance.

Garveyism and the NAACP

- Marcus Garvey founded the Universal Negro Improvement Association promoting Black nationalism, Pan-Africanism, economic self-sufficiency, and "Back to Africa" movement.
- UNIA reached 2-4 million members.
- The NAACP, co-founded by W.E.B. Du Bois, pursued integration through legal challenges and political lobbying.
- Membership grew from 9,000 (1917) to 100,000 (1930).
- These organizations represented different strategies—separation versus integration—for advancing African American rights.

Key Figures

Ida B. Wells-Barnett

Journalist & anti-lynching crusader (1862-1931)



Mary Garrity, c1893 [National Portrait Gallery](#)

- Investigated and exposed lynching with hard data
- Published pamphlets documenting mob violence
- Co-founded the NAACP and pressed for federal anti-lynching law

STRATEGY Lead with Wells to show civil-rights advancement, not only the era's backlash.

Marcus Garvey

Black-nationalist leader (Garveyism)



George Grantham Bain, 1922 [Library of Congress](#)

- Founded the Universal Negro Improvement Association
- Preached Black pride, self-reliance, and pan-African unity
- Built the largest Black mass movement of the era

STRATEGY Contrast Garvey's separatism with the NAACP's integration strategy so students see competing visions.

A. Mitchell Palmer

U.S. Attorney General (Red Scare)

- Directed the Palmer Raids against suspected radicals (1919-1920)
- Deported hundreds of immigrants without trial
- Embodied the postwar fear of communism

STRATEGY Use Palmer to frame the liberty-vs-security debate at the center of the Red Scare.

Ida B. Wells Anti-Lynching Pamphlet

Close Reading

Ida B. Wells-Barnett • 1909

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Mary Garrity, c1893 [National Portrait Gallery](#)

"The student of American sociology will find the year 1894 marked by a pronounced increase in the number of lynchings. The statistics compiled show that more than ten thousand Negroes have been killed... The alleged causes of lynching do not explain it. It is an excuse to get rid of Negroes who are acquiring wealth and property and thus keep the race terrorized."

CONTEXT

Ida B. Wells-Barnett was one of the most courageous journalists and civil rights activists in American history. In the 1890s, she conducted a careful investigation of lynching in the American South, documenting that many of the supposed justifications for mob killings were false — particularly the claim that lynching punished Black men for sexual assault. Wells-Barnett published her findings at enormous personal risk (a Memphis newspaper office where she worked was burned) and brought the issue of lynching to national and international attention. Though published in 1909, her anti-lynching pamphlets remained essential reading during the 1920s, when lynching persisted and Congress repeatedly failed to pass anti-lynching legislation.

ANALYZE

What does Ida B. Wells argue was the true cause of lynching?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Ida B. Wells-Barnett	1909	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

First Red Scare

Primer Susto Rojo

FR

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

KKK Resurgence

Resurgimiento del KKK

KR

The Ku Klux Klan's revival in the 1920s, expanding beyond the South to target not just African Americans but also Catholics, Jews, immigrants, and others, reaching 4-5 million members.

Ida B. Wells-Barnett

Ida B. Wells-Barnett

say: EYE-duh bee wellz BAR-net

IB

An investigative journalist and civil rights activist who led anti-lynching crusades, exposing the truth about racial violence through fearless reporting and organizing.

Immigration Quota Acts

Leyes de Cuotas de Inmigración

IQ

The 1921 and 1924 laws that drastically limited immigration, especially from Southern and Eastern Europe, Asia, and Africa, based on racist national origins formulas.

Tulsa Race Massacre

Masacre Racial de Tulsa

say: TUL-suh rays MASS-uh-ker

TR

The May 31-June 1, 1921 attack on Tulsa's prosperous Black Greenwood district ("Black Wall Street") by white mobs, killing an estimated 300 Black residents and destroying 1,200 homes and businesses.

Garveyism

Garveyismo

say: GAR-vee-iz-um

G

Marcus Garvey's movement promoting Black pride, economic independence, and pan-African unity, advocating for African Americans to build their own businesses and even return to Africa.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

**Weigh advancement vs.
backlash**

MODEL PROMPT: Was the 1920s a step forward or backward for civil liberties?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

The Klan revived and the Red Scare crushed dissent (backlash), but Wells, Garvey, and the NAACP organized and fought back (advancement). Both happened at once.

THINK ALOUD

Sort each event into *ADVANCEMENT* or *BACKLASH*.

→ **Now you try:** *Take a side and support it with one advancement and one backlash from the text.*

Fear in the Roaring Twenties — Civil Liberties Under Pressure

Groups of 3

15 min

YOUR TASK

Using the Immigration Act of 1924 and the Ida B. Wells anti-lynching pamphlet, complete an organizer covering three threats to civil liberties in the 1920s: the First Red Scare and Palmer Raids, the revived Ku Klux Klan, and the immigration quota laws. For each, note WHO was targeted and HOW. Then write a one-sentence claim explaining what best accounts for this surge of fear and intolerance.



National Photo Company / Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1926
[Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed three-threat organizer (target + method for each) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim about the cause of 1920s intolerance.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Organizer with the three threats pre-labeled and a fact bank of targets and methods.
Honors: Write a paragraph connecting one 1920s restriction on liberty to its long-term consequences, using evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us35-civil-liberties.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What does Ida B. Wells argue was the true cause of lynching?

A Economic jealousy and desire to prevent Black economic success through terror

B Punishment for actual crimes committed by the victims

C Lack of effective law enforcement in Southern rural areas

D Religious conflicts between different racial and ethnic groups

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What does Ida B. Wells argue was the true cause of lynching?

A Economic jealousy and desire to prevent Black economic success through terror ✓

B Punishment for actual crimes committed by the victims

C Lack of effective law enforcement in Southern rural areas

D Religious conflicts between different racial and ethnic groups

Correct answer: A. Why: Wells argues "alleged causes... do not explain it" and that lynching is "an excuse to get rid of Negroes who are acquiring wealth and property."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- First Red Scare (1919-1920)
- Immigration Quota Acts of the 1920s
- Resurgence of the Ku Klux Klan
- Ida B. Wells (1862-1931)
- Garveyism and the NAACP

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: What best explains the surge of fear and intolerance in the 1920s, economic anxiety, wartime hostility, or racial and ethnic prejudice? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how the 1920s limited civil liberties even as popular culture celebrated freedom. Give two specific examples.

STANDARD

US.36

The Scopes Trial

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

SSP.02

Examine a source

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the Scopes Trial of 1925, including the major figures (i.e., John Scopes, William Jennings Bryan, and Clarence Darrow), two sides of the controversy (i.e., fundamentalism and modernism), the outcome, and the legacy.

I CAN

I can describe the Scopes Trial of 1925, including the major figures, the two sides of the controversy (fundamentalism and modernism), the outcome, and the legacy.

Words you need before we read

■ First Red Scare

En español: *Primer Susto Rojo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

■ Immigration Quota Acts

En español: *Leyes de Cuotas de Inmigración*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1921 and 1924 laws that drastically limited immigration, especially from Southern and Eastern Europe, Asia, and Africa, based on racist national origins formulas.

■ KKK Resurgence

En español: *Resurgimiento del KKK*

WHAT IT MEANS

The Ku Klux Klan's revival in the 1920s, expanding beyond the South to target not just African Americans but also Catholics, Jews, immigrants, and others, reaching 4-5 million members.

Check your understanding

Compare the different approaches of Ida B. Wells, Marcus Garvey, and the NAACP in fighting for African American rights.

- A** All three used identical approaches, which does not align with the documented historical record, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which does not align with the documented historical record
- B** None of these figures had significant impact, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work, which does not align with the documented historical record, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- C** They all opposed civil rights, but this oversimplifies the complex factors at work when examined alongside the available primary and secondary sources, which represents a common misconception about this historical period and fails to account for key developments in the broader context
- D** Wells used investigative journalism to expose lynching; Garvey promoted Black nationalism, economic self-sufficiency, and separatism; NAACP pursued integration through legal challenges—representing diverse strategies from documentation to separation to integration ✓ KEY

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.35 What was the First Red Scare?

2

US.35 What did the Immigration (Quota) Acts of the 1920s do?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What was the Scopes Trial?

✓ ANSWER

The 1925 Tennessee trial of a teacher for teaching evolution, a clash of religion and science.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the summer of 1925, in the small town of Dayton, Tennessee, a high school teacher went on trial for teaching evolution, and two of the most famous lawyers in America turned a local courtroom into a national showdown over science and the Bible.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

When a community's deepest beliefs collide with new scientific ideas, who should decide what gets taught in a public school classroom?

Major Figures and Their Roles

- John T. Scopes was a 24-year-old high school teacher in Dayton, Tennessee who volunteered to test the Butler Act.
- William Jennings Bryan, three-time presidential candidate and fundamentalist champion, led the prosecution.
- Clarence Darrow, famous criminal lawyer and religious skeptic, led the defense.
- Judge John Raulston favored the prosecution.
- H.L. Mencken covered the trial for national audiences, coining the term "Monkey Trial."

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The Scopes Trial was a conflict between _____ and _____, and it revealed that _____.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1925 [Library of Congress](#)

★ **TENNESSEE CONNECTION**

The Scopes Trial took place in Dayton, Tennessee, in July 1925, after the state legislature passed the Butler Act banning the teaching of evolution in public schools. Tennessee became the national stage for the clash between science and religion.

TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Arguments Against Evolution (Prosecution)

- The prosecution argued that the Bible is the literal word of God and scientifically accurate.
- They claimed evolution undermined religious faith and moral behavior.
- They asserted that parents and taxpayers should control school curriculum.
- Traditional religious values were deemed necessary for social order, and schools should teach established truth, not controversial theories.

Arguments For Evolution (Defense)

- The defense argued that evolution was supported by overwhelming scientific evidence.
- Teachers should be free to teach accepted scientific theories.
- Separation of church and state prohibited establishing religious doctrine in schools.
- Students needed modern scientific education to compete.
- Many Christians already accepted evolution as God's method of creation.

Trial Outcome and Immediate Impact

- Scopes was convicted and fined \$100, though the conviction was later overturned on a technicality.
- The Butler Act remained in effect until 1967.
- Darrow's cross-examination of Bryan exposed inconsistencies in Biblical literalism.
- The trial became a media circus broadcast on radio.
- Afterward, publishers removed evolution from textbooks, and many teachers avoided the subject for decades.

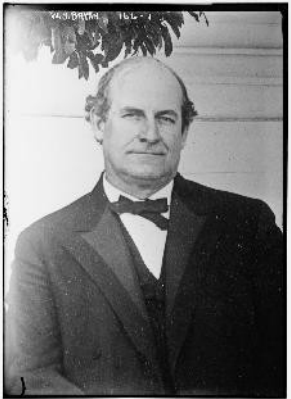
Long-term Legacy

- The Scopes Trial became a symbol of science versus religion conflict.
- It established templates for ongoing debates about curriculum control and academic freedom.
- The trial portrayed religious conservatives as anti-intellectual, reinforcing regional stereotypes about the South.
- It foreshadowed later Supreme Court cases on religion in schools and inspired cultural works including "Inherit the Wind."

Key Figures

William Jennings Bryan

Prosecutor & fundamentalist orator



Library of Congress, c1920s [Library of Congress](#)

- Argued for the state and against teaching evolution
- Defended a literal reading of the Bible
- Voice of rural, fundamentalist America

STRATEGY Pair Bryan and Darrow back-to-back so students hear both sides of the culture clash in their own words.

Clarence Darrow

Defense attorney & modernist



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1925 [Library of Congress](#)

- Defended teacher John Scopes
- Cross-examined Bryan on the Bible
- Voice of urban, modernist America

STRATEGY Use Darrow's cross-examination to model how a lawyer builds an argument from questions.

John Scopes

Dayton, Tennessee teacher

- Agreed to be charged for teaching evolution
- Made his classroom a test case for the Butler Act
- Became the human center of a national debate

STRATEGY Anchor the trial in Tennessee: Scopes and the Butler Act make this a local story with national stakes.

Clarence Darrow Cross-Examination of Bryan

Close Reading

Trial Transcript • 1925

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Library of Congress, Prints and Photographs Division, 1925 [Library of Congress](#)

"DARROW: Do you think the earth was made in six days? BRYAN: Not six days of twenty-four hours... My impression is they were periods. DARROW: Now, if you call those periods, they might have been a very long time? BRYAN: They might have been. DARROW: The creation might have been going on for a very long time? BRYAN: It might have continued for millions of years."

CONTEXT

The Scopes Trial's most dramatic moment came when defense attorney Clarence Darrow — the most famous trial lawyer in America — put prosecution witness William Jennings Bryan on the stand and cross-examined him about his literal interpretation of the Bible. The exchange lasted two hours and was devastating: Darrow got Bryan to admit he hadn't studied ancient languages, that he believed a day in Genesis might have lasted millions of years, and that he accepted what experts told him. The trial transcript captured a moment when the conflict between religious fundamentalism and scientific modernity played out in the most personal and dramatic way possible, revealing both men at their most human.

ANALYZE

What did Clarence Darrow accomplish by questioning Bryan about the "six days" of creation?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Trial Transcript	1925	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Scopes Trial

Juicio de Scopes

ST

The 1925 "Monkey Trial" in Dayton, Tennessee, where teacher John Scopes was prosecuted for teaching evolution, symbolizing the clash between modernism and fundamentalism.

Modernism

Modernismo

say: MOD-ern-iz-um

M

A cultural movement embracing science, reason, and social change, including acceptance of evolution, urban lifestyles, and challenges to traditional religious and moral values.

First Red Scare

Primer Susto Rojo

FR

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

Fundamentalism

Fundamentalismo

say: fun-duh-MEN-tuh-liz-um

F

A religious movement emphasizing literal interpretation of the Bible, traditional values, and opposition to modernist ideas like evolution, gaining strength in the 1920s.

Grand Ole Opry

Grand Ole Opry

say: grand ohl AH-pree

GO

A weekly country music radio show that began in Nashville in 1925, becoming the longest-running radio broadcast in U.S. history and establishing Nashville as country music's capital.

Immigration Quota Acts

Leyes de Cuotas de Inmigración

IQ

The 1921 and 1924 laws that drastically limited immigration, especially from Southern and Eastern Europe, Asia, and Africa, based on racist national origins formulas.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Compare competing arguments

MODEL PROMPT: How did Bryan and Darrow frame the fight over evolution?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Bryan defends the literal Bible and majority rule; Darrow defends science and free inquiry. It is fundamentalism versus modernism.

THINK ALOUD

Label each man's core value: tradition or science.

→ **Now you try:** *State which argument you find stronger and quote one line to support it.*

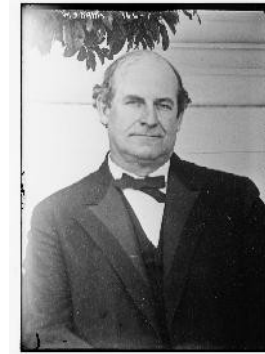
Science on Trial — The Scopes Showdown

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the Tennessee Butler Act and the excerpt of Darrow's cross-examination of Bryan. Build a two-column chart contrasting the PROSECUTION (fundamentalism, Bryan) and the DEFENSE (modernism, Darrow): for each side list the main argument, one piece of evidence, and what they wanted for public schools. Then write a one-sentence claim on whether the trial settled the science-vs-religion conflict or simply exposed it.



Library of Congress, c1920s [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed prosecution/defense chart (argument, evidence, goal for schools) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chart pre-labeled 'Prosecution' and 'Defense' with a word bank of arguments to sort.
Honors: Write a paragraph connecting the Scopes Trial's rural-vs-urban divide to another 1920s conflict from the unit.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us36-scopes-trial.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 3

EOC PRACTICE

What did Clarence Darrow accomplish by questioning Bryan about the "six days" of creation?

- A** He proved that evolution was scientifically accurate beyond doubt
- B** He showed that even Bryan did not interpret the Bible entirely literally
- C** He convinced Bryan to support teaching evolution in schools
- D** He demonstrated that the Bible and science were completely compatible

ANSWER FIRST: *students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.*

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What did Clarence Darrow accomplish by questioning Bryan about the "six days" of creation?

- A He proved that evolution was scientifically accurate beyond doubt
- B He showed that even Bryan did not interpret the Bible entirely literally ✓**
- C He convinced Bryan to support teaching evolution in schools
- D He demonstrated that the Bible and science were completely compatible

Correct answer: B. Why: Bryan admitted the "six days" might be "periods" lasting "millions of years"—showing he didn't interpret the Bible entirely literally, undermining the fundamentalist position.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Major Figures and Their Roles
- Arguments Against Evolution (Prosecution)
- Arguments For Evolution (Defense)
- Trial Outcome and Immediate Impact
- Long-term Legacy

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** **DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation**

*Evaluate: Did the Scopes Trial settle the conflict between science and religion in public schools, or simply expose it?
Defend your claim with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain what the Scopes Trial revealed about the divisions in 1920s America. Identify the two sides and what each wanted.

STANDARD

US.37

Prohibition & Its Impact on American Society

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Describe the impacts of Prohibition on American society, including: the rise of organized crime, bootlegging, and speakeasies.

I CAN

I can describe the impacts of Prohibition on American society, including the rise of organized crime, bootlegging, and speakeasies.

Words you need before we read

■ Scopes Trial

En español: *Juicio de Scopes*

WHAT IT MEANS

The 1925 "Monkey Trial" in Dayton, Tennessee, where teacher John Scopes was prosecuted for teaching evolution, symbolizing the clash between modernism and fundamentalism.

■ Fundamentalism

En español: *Fundamentalismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A religious movement emphasizing literal interpretation of the Bible, traditional values, and opposition to modernist ideas like evolution, gaining strength in the 1920s.

■ Modernism

En español: *Modernismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A cultural movement embracing science, reason, and social change, including acceptance of evolution, urban lifestyles, and challenges to traditional religious and moral values.

Check your understanding

How did the confrontation between William Jennings Bryan and Clarence Darrow symbolize broader cultural conflicts in 1920s America?

- A** Bryan represented traditional, rural, religious America defending Biblical authority while Darrow represented modern, urban, secular America promoting scientific thinking—symbolizing the era's urban-rural and tradition-modernity divides ✓ KEY
- B** Bryan and Darrow had similar viewpoints, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period despite the fact that multiple contemporary sources contradict this
- C** The confrontation was purely legal, not cultural, but the historical record tells a more complex story, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, but contemporary accounts and primary sources suggest otherwise
- D** Neither figure was significant to the trial, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, which does not align with the documented historical record, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.36 What was the Scopes Trial about?

2

US.36 What was the difference between fundamentalism and modernism in the 1920s?

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What did Prohibition make illegal?

✓ ANSWER

The making, selling, and transporting of alcoholic beverages across the United States.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In 1920 the United States did something no other nation had tried: it amended its own Constitution to ban the making, selling, and transporting of alcohol across the entire country.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

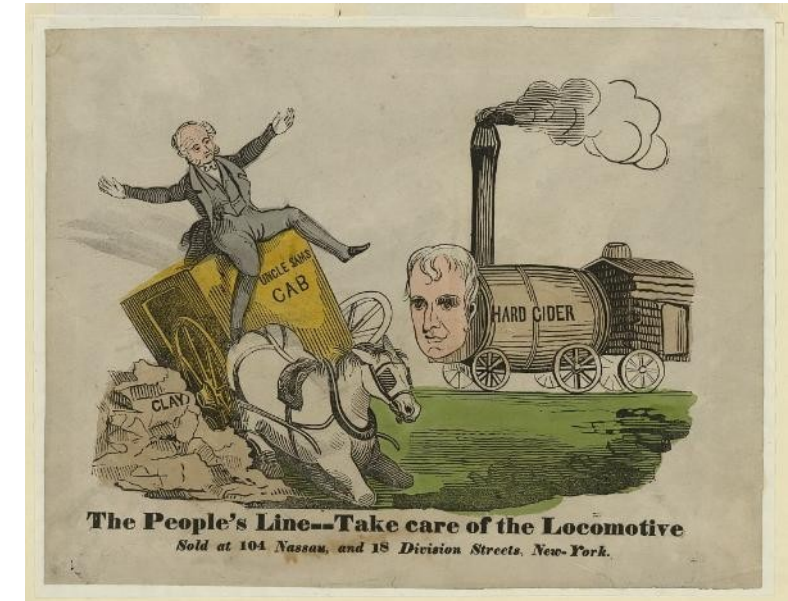
What happens when a government outlaws something millions of its citizens refuse to give up, and who ends up profiting from the ban?

Implementation and Intended Effects

- The 18th Amendment (1919) prohibited manufacture, sale, and transportation of alcohol.
- The Volstead Act defined "intoxicating liquors" as containing over 0.5% alcohol.
- The temperance movement, religious groups, and progressive reformers supported Prohibition to reduce crime, improve health, strengthen families, and increase worker productivity.
- Only 1,500 federal agents were available for enforcement.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

Prohibition was meant to _____, but it actually led to _____.



Pease, Lute, 1869-1963, artist, [between 1917 and 1920] [Library of Congress](#)

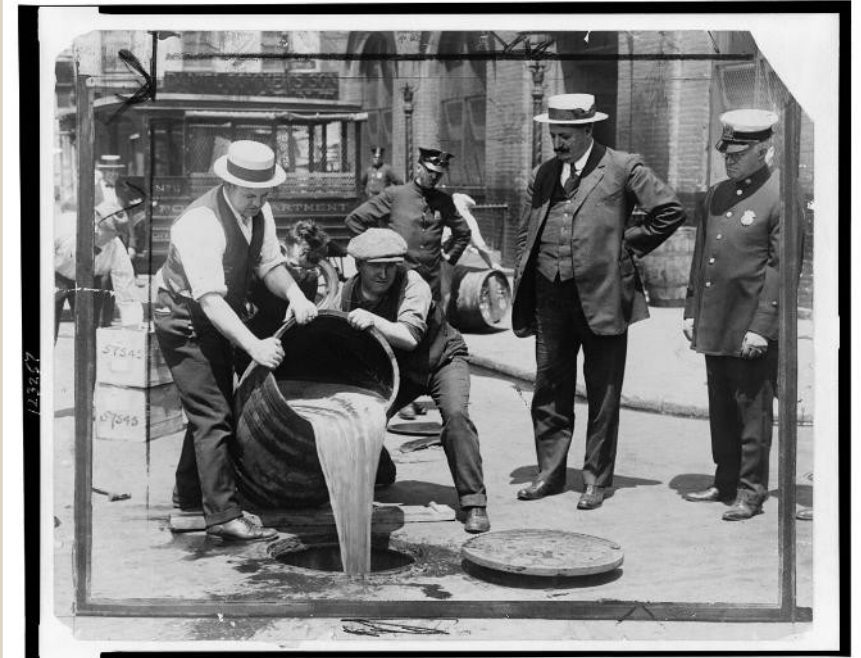
TEACHER CUE Chunk → cold-call → confirm before advancing.

Rise of Organized Crime

- Illegal alcohol created enormous profits with relatively low risk.
- Al Capone controlled Chicago operations with an estimated \$60 million annual income.
- Organized crime bribed police, judges, and politicians.
- Gang warfare including the St. Valentine's Day Massacre (1929) demonstrated violence.
- Criminal organizations developed national networks and diversified into gambling and other illegal activities.

Bootlegging Methods and Consequences

- Alcohol was produced through home distillation ("bathtub gin"), stolen and redistilled industrial alcohol, smuggling from Canada and Caribbean, and abuse of medicinal and religious exemptions.
- Rumrunners, cars, and trucks distributed illegal alcohol.
- Poisonous industrial alcohol killed thousands.
- Widespread bribery undermined law enforcement, and only 5% of illegal alcohol was estimated to be intercepted.



News photo, c1921 [Library of Congress](#)

Speakeasies and Social Culture

- Speakeasies were secret bars in basements and disguised establishments, often requiring passwords for entry.
- They featured jazz music, dancing, and diverse clientele mixing social classes and sometimes races.
- Women drank publicly in unprecedented numbers.
- Speakeasies promoted flapper culture and created modern nightclub atmosphere.
- They represented open defiance of Prohibition law.

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

Tennessee had gone dry years before national Prohibition, and moonshining in the Appalachian hills and hollows of East Tennessee became legendary, feeding both the illegal liquor trade and later the roots of stock-car racing.

End of Prohibition

- The Great Depression made alcohol tax revenue attractive.
- Public opinion blamed Prohibition for organized crime.
- Obvious enforcement failure undermined the law.
- The 21st Amendment (1933) repealed Prohibition, returning alcohol regulation to states.
- Criminal networks established during Prohibition persisted for decades, and the experiment demonstrated limitations of legislating moral behavior.

Key Figure

Al Capone

Chicago organized-crime boss



Chicago Bureau (news photo), 1930
[Wikimedia Commons](#) (public domain)

- Built a criminal empire on illegal liquor
- Made millions from bootlegging and speakeasies
- Symbolized the violent, unintended costs of Prohibition

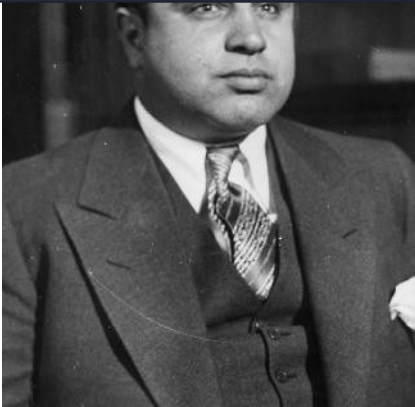
STRATEGY Use Capone's own interview to show how the criminal justified himself, then have students judge the claim.

Al Capone Interview

Argumentation

Al Capone (as quoted in newspaper) • 1930

ZOOM IN Find ONE detail that surprises you — be ready to name it.



Chicago Bureau (news photo), 1930 [Wikimedia Commons \(public domain\)](#)

"I make my money by supplying a public demand. If I break the law, my customers, who number hundreds of the best people in Chicago, are as guilty as I am. The only difference between us is that I sell and they buy. Everybody calls me a racketeer. I call myself a businessman. When I sell liquor, it's bootlegging. When my patrons serve it on silver trays on Lake Shore Drive, it's hospitality."

CONTEXT

Al Capone was the most famous American criminal of the 20th century, building a Chicago bootlegging empire worth an estimated \$60 million per year during Prohibition. The son of Italian immigrants from Brooklyn, Capone rose through organized crime to control Chicago's illegal liquor trade, gambling, and prostitution, corrupting hundreds of police officers and politicians. He was a public celebrity who gave interviews and attended baseball games, projecting an image of a businessman providing a service the public wanted. The federal government finally convicted him on tax evasion charges in 1931 — they couldn't prove the murders and bootlegging — and he spent eight years in prison. He became the enduring symbol of Prohibition's failure.

ANALYZE

How did Al Capone justify his bootlegging activities?

SOURCE IT FIRST	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
SSP.02 • before you interpret	Al Capone (as quoted in newspaper)	1930	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Prohibition

Prohibición

say: proh-uh-BISH-un

P

The nationwide constitutional ban on the manufacture, sale, and transport of alcoholic beverages, in effect from 1920 to 1933 under the 18th Amendment.

Bootlegging

Contrabando de Alcohol

say: BOOT-leg-ing

B

The illegal production, smuggling, and distribution of alcohol during Prohibition.

First Red Scare

Primer Susto Rojo

FR

A period of intense fear of communism and radical political activity following World War I (1919-1920), leading to deportations, arrests, and violations of civil liberties.

Organized Crime

Crimen Organizado

OC

Structured criminal enterprises that expanded dramatically during Prohibition by controlling the illegal liquor trade, led by figures such as Al Capone in Chicago.

Speakeasy

Bar Clandestino

say: SPEEK-ee-zee

S

An illicit establishment that sold alcoholic beverages during Prohibition, often hidden behind ordinary storefronts.

Consumerism

Consumismo

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze unintended
consequences

MODEL PROMPT: Why did a law meant to reduce vice increase crime?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Banning liquor did not end demand; it moved supply to criminals like Capone, who got rich on bootlegging and speakeasies.

THINK ALOUD

Match the intended effect to its actual, opposite result.

→ **Now you try:** *Explain to a partner why Prohibition was eventually repealed.*

The Great Experiment — Why Prohibition Backfired

Pairs

12 min

YOUR TASK

Read the 18th Amendment text and the Al Capone interview. Create a cause-and-effect chain: start with the goals of Prohibition (why reformers wanted it), then trace the unintended effects (organized crime, bootlegging, speakeasies, disrespect for the law), and end with repeal in 1933. Include at least four links. Finish with a one-sentence claim on whether Prohibition was a well-meaning reform undone by human nature or a doomed overreach.



News photo, c1921 [Library of Congress](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed cause-and-effect chain (goals -> effects -> repeal, 4+ links) AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Chain with the links provided out of order to sequence, plus a word bank. Honors: Write a paragraph explaining how Capone's own words reveal why Prohibition was impossible to enforce, quoting the interview.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us37-prohibition.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 1

EOC PRACTICE

How did Al Capone justify his bootlegging activities?

- A** He claimed to be fighting against an unjust government policy
- B** He argued he was simply a businessman meeting public demand, no different from his wealthy customers
- C** He admitted his activities were criminal and asked for mercy
- D** He blamed the police for not enforcing the law consistently

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

How did Al Capone justify his bootlegging activities?

- A** He claimed to be fighting against an unjust government policy
- B** He argued he was simply a businessman meeting public demand, no different from his wealthy customers ✓
- C** He admitted his activities were criminal and asked for mercy
- D** He blamed the police for not enforcing the law consistently

Correct answer: B. Why: Capone argues he supplies "a public demand" and that his customers "are as guilty as I am"—he's a "businessman" while wealthy patrons call it "hospitality."

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Implementation and Intended Effects
- Rise of Organized Crime
- Bootlegging Methods and Consequences
- Speakeasies and Social Culture
- End of Prohibition

★ HONORS / EXTENSION DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

Evaluate: Was Prohibition a well-meaning reform undone by human nature, or a doomed overreach of government power from the start? Argue with evidence. (SSP.04)

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain why Prohibition was passed and why it ultimately failed. Give one reason for each.

STANDARD

US.38

Credit, Consumerism & Financial Speculation

SOCIAL STUDIES PRACTICES

SSP.02

Examine a source

SSP.04

Build an argument

SSP.06

Geographic awareness

TN ACADEMIC STANDARD

Analyze the changes in the economy and culture of the U.S. as a result of credit expansion, consumerism, and financial speculation.

I CAN

I can analyze the changes in the economy and culture of the United States as a result of credit expansion, consumerism, and financial speculation.

Words you need before we read

■ Prohibition

En español: *Prohibición*

WHAT IT MEANS

The nationwide constitutional ban on the manufacture, sale, and transport of alcoholic beverages, in effect from 1920 to 1933 under the 18th Amendment.

■ Organized Crime

En español: *Crimen Organizado*

WHAT IT MEANS

Structured criminal enterprises that expanded dramatically during Prohibition by controlling the illegal liquor trade, led by figures such as Al Capone in Chicago.

■ Bootlegging

En español: *Contrabando de Alcohol*

WHAT IT MEANS

The illegal production, smuggling, and distribution of alcohol during Prohibition.

Check your understanding

Evaluate whether Prohibition caused more harm than good to American society.

- A Prohibition was clearly beneficial overall, despite the fact that multiple sources contradict this view, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors involved, which represents a common misconception about this historical period
- B Prohibition created organized crime, caused deaths from poisonous alcohol, corrupted officials, overwhelmed law enforcement, and undermined respect for law while failing to stop drinking—its harms far outweighed any benefits** ✓ KEY
- C Prohibition had no significant effects, which represents a common misconception about the period, which contradicts the primary source evidence from this era, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence
- D Prohibition successfully reduced alcohol consumption, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, though this interpretation lacks supporting historical evidence, and this view has been largely revised by modern historical research

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.

Do You Remember?

Before we start, retrieve what we have already learned. Answer from memory first — no notes.

1

US.37 What did Prohibition ban, and what amendment created it?

2

US.37 Name one major unintended consequence of Prohibition.

Warm-Up — Quick Recall

DOK 1

LOW STAKES

Everyone can answer this. Thumbs / whiteboards — no notes.

What does it mean to 'buy on credit'?

✓ **ANSWER**

To purchase goods now and pay for them over time in installments, rather than all at once.

COMMIT FIRST: *have everyone answer before the reveal — this is the DOK 1 floor; the graded check later in this lesson moves up to DOK 2–3.*

Think About It

In the 1920s Americans discovered they could buy a car, a radio, or a refrigerator today and pay for it later, and millions rushed to borrow money to buy stocks they were sure would only go up.

DISCUSS

TIMING: Turn & Talk 60 sec → cold-call 2 pairs

If everyone is borrowing to buy and betting the good times will never end, what happens when the bill finally comes due?

Credit Expansion and Economic Growth

- Installment buying ("buy now, pay later") made expensive goods affordable.
- Consumer debt increased from \$3.3 billion (1920) to \$7.6 billion (1929).
- By 1929, 75% of cars were purchased on credit.
- Banks and retailers offered loans for automobiles, appliances, and homes.
- Credit-driven demand increased production and employment, but also accumulated unsustainable debt levels.

SENTENCE FRAME (EL & writing support)

The prosperity of the 1920s was built on _____, which was dangerous because _____.

Consumerism and Cultural Change

- Purchasing goods became central to American identity and status.
- Mass production made standardized products available to broad populations.
- Advertising created brand loyalty through emotional appeals rather than just product information.
- Lifestyle marketing sold products as means to achieve desired lifestyles.
- Success became increasingly measured by possessions rather than character.

Financial Speculation

- Investors could buy stocks with as little as 10% down payment (buying on margin).
- Speculation fever meant ordinary Americans invested life savings in the stock market.
- Stock prices rose far beyond companies' actual worth, creating an investment bubble.
- Margin requirements meant small price declines triggered forced selling that accelerated market drops.



News photo, 1929 [U.S. Social Security Administration](#)

Interconnections Creating Vulnerability

- Credit enabled consumer purchases and stock investments, driving production and corporate profits higher.
- Rising asset values encouraged more lending.
- This cycle created an unsustainable bubble.
- Warning signs included overproduction, income inequality limiting purchasing power, and debt levels beyond what the economy could support.

Technology and Advertising Impact

- Radio and magazines enabled national advertising campaigns that used psychological appeals.
- Household appliances—refrigerators, washing machines, vacuum cleaners—changed domestic life.
- Automobiles made middle-class families mobile.
- These technologies, promoted through advertising, created consumer expectations and desires that drove purchasing and economic growth.

Key Figure

Calvin Coolidge

30th President (1923-1929)



Library of Congress, c1923 [Library of Congress](#)

- 'The chief business of the American people is business'
- Cut taxes and championed pro-business policy
- Presided over the late-1920s boom before the crash

STRATEGY Use Coolidge to name the pro-business optimism that made speculation feel safe - then set up US.38's hidden risks.

General Motors Installment Plan Advertisement

Close Reading

General Motors Acceptance Corporation • 1926

"Why wait? Drive the car you want NOW and pay for it as you ride. GMAC Time Payment Plan makes it possible for every family to enjoy the benefits of automobile ownership. A small down payment puts you behind the wheel today. Easy monthly payments fit your budget. Don't deny yourself the pleasure and convenience of a new car."

READ CLOSELY Underline the exact words that answer the ANALYZE question — be ready to read them aloud.

CONTEXT

The 1920s saw an unprecedented expansion of consumer credit and installment buying. Before the 1920s, buying on credit was considered shameful — a sign of living beyond one's means. The automobile industry changed this: in 1919, only 4% of car purchases were made on credit; by 1927, nearly two-thirds were. General Motors Acceptance Corporation (GMAC), founded in 1919, was the pioneer of consumer auto financing. The expansion of consumer credit helped fuel the 1920s boom — allowing Americans to buy goods they couldn't afford with cash — but also created a fragile economy heavily dependent on continued consumer confidence and ability to make payments. When the Depression hit, many families couldn't make their installment payments and lost both their goods and their credit.

ANALYZE

What new purchasing practice does this advertisement promote?

SOURCE IT FIRST SSP.02 • before you interpret	WHO made it?	WHEN?	WHY does it matter?
	General Motors Acceptance Corporation	1926	Consider the author's purpose and audience before reading the words.

Source: [Library of Congress](#)

Word Wall

Buying on Credit

Compra a Crédito

BO

The practice of purchasing goods with borrowed money repaid over time in installments, which fueled 1920s consumer spending.

Stock Speculation

Especulación Bursátil

SS

The practice of buying stocks - frequently on margin with borrowed money - in the hope of selling at a higher price for quick profit.

Assembly Line

Línea de Ensamblaje

AL

A manufacturing method where workers remain stationary while products move past them on a conveyor belt, with each worker performing one specific task, dramatically increasing efficiency.

Consumerism

Consumismo

say: kun-SOO-mer-iz-um

C

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

Automobile Impact

Impacto del Automóvil

AI

The widespread adoption of cars in the 1920s transformed American society, creating suburbs, highways, tourism, and related industries like gas stations, motels, and drive-in restaurants.

Motion Pictures

Imágenes en Movimiento

MP

Silent and "talkie" films that became America's most popular entertainment in the 1920s, creating celebrity culture and Hollywood as the film capital of the world.

"say:" pronunciation guide (stressed syllable in CAPS) and a per-term visual anchor support newcomer English learners. Spanish term + full bilingual Frayer models are in the unit vocabulary set.

Let's Work One Together

Analyze economic causation

MODEL PROMPT: How did credit and speculation make the boom fragile?

WORKED EXAMPLE (teacher models this aloud)

Buying on credit and stocks on margin let people spend money they did not have. When prices stalled, the debt remained - a hidden risk beneath the boom.

THINK ALOUD

Circle each use of borrowed money in the section.

→ **Now you try:** *Predict one way this borrowing could turn a boom into a bust.*

Buy Now, Pay Later — The Fragile Boom

Pairs

15 min

YOUR TASK

Read the General Motors installment-plan ad and President Coolidge's statement. Build a flowchart showing how buying on credit and stock speculation fueled 1920s prosperity, then mark the HIDDEN DANGER at each step (rising debt, buying stocks 'on margin,' overconfidence, uneven incomes). End with a one-sentence claim on how 'real' 1920s prosperity was versus how much rested on borrowed money and confidence.



News photo, 1929 [U.S. Social Security Administration](#)

DELIVERABLE

Completed prosperity-to-danger flowchart (boom drivers + hidden risks)
AND a one-sentence evidence-based claim.

DIFFERENTIATION

Entry: Flowchart with boom drivers pre-labeled and a word bank of hidden dangers to match.
Honors: Write a paragraph predicting, from 1928, what could cause this credit-and-speculation economy to collapse, using two pieces of evidence.

Companion printable: [cornell-notes/unit-4/us38-credit-consumerism.pdf](#)

TCAP-Style Question

DOK 2

EOC PRACTICE

What new purchasing practice does this advertisement promote?

- A** Saving money for years before making major purchases
- B** Buying expensive items on credit with small payments over time
- C** Sharing automobiles among multiple families to reduce costs
- D** Leasing vehicles from dealerships instead of owning them

ANSWER FIRST: students commit — then click / advance to reveal the correct answer and explanation.

TCAP-Style Question

✓ ANSWER KEY

What new purchasing practice does this advertisement promote?

- A Saving money for years before making major purchases
- B Buying expensive items on credit with small payments over time ✓**
- C Sharing automobiles among multiple families to reduce costs
- D Leasing vehicles from dealerships instead of owning them

Correct answer: B. Why: The ad promotes buying "NOW and pay for it as you ride" with "A small down payment" and "Easy monthly payments"—credit purchasing.

What You Need to Know for TCAP

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Credit Expansion and Economic Growth
- Consumerism and Cultural Change
- Financial Speculation
- Interconnections Creating Vulnerability
- Technology and Advertising Impact

★ **HONORS / EXTENSION** DOK 3 · SSP.04 Argumentation

*Evaluate: To what extent was the prosperity of the 1920s 'real' versus built on borrowed money and false confidence?
Argue your position with evidence. (SSP.04)*

EXIT TICKET

DOK 2

Explain how buying on credit and stock speculation fueled 1920s prosperity AND created hidden dangers.

Unit 4 Complete

The 1920s (1919–1929) · from the Great Migration and the Harlem Renaissance to the assembly line, Prohibition, and a boom built on borrowed money.

Revisit your unit hook: How did one decade transform American life — and why did the boom end in crisis? You can now answer with evidence — from radio and Lindbergh to the Scopes Trial, Prohibition, and buying stocks on margin.

Next: Unit 5 — The Great Depression & the New Deal

Words you need before we read

■ Buying on Credit

En español: *Compra a Crédito*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of purchasing goods with borrowed money repaid over time in installments, which fueled 1920s consumer spending.

■ Consumerism

En español: *Consumismo*

WHAT IT MEANS

A culture of increased purchasing of consumer goods, driven in the 1920s by mass production, national advertising, and installment credit.

■ Stock Speculation

En español: *Especulación Bursátil*

WHAT IT MEANS

The practice of buying stocks - frequently on margin with borrowed money - in the hope of selling at a higher price for quick profit.

Check your understanding

Analyze how credit expansion, consumerism, and speculation worked together to create both prosperity and economic vulnerability.

- A These factors were unrelated, although this overlooks critical economic and social factors, but the historical evidence paints a more nuanced picture and oversimplifies the complex factors at work during this period
- B These factors created only prosperity, not vulnerability, but the historical record tells a more complex story and fails to account for key developments in the broader context, although historical sources do not support this conclusion
- C Credit enabled consumption and speculation, which drove production and stock prices higher, encouraging more lending in a cycle that created apparent prosperity while building unsustainable debt and inflated asset values that would collapse ✓ KEY**
- D Economic vulnerability came from foreign sources, which ignores key developments that shaped the outcome and does not reflect the scholarly consensus on this topic, which does not align with the documented historical record

UDL · ACTION & EXPRESSION → STRATEGY DEVELOPMENT

MTSS: below mastery → targeted reteach (Tier 2); at/above → extension. The goal never lowers.